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2 INTRODUCTION

2.1 THE SOUL

Before delving into the various phases the soul and body experience and the details of each phase, a brief understanding of the soul is required. The reality and details of the soul is a highly debated topic among scholars. There are two main groups regarding this discussion. The first group maintains that remaining silent on this matter is preferred as this is something that Allah has not informed humans of. The second group delves into the reality of the soul in much detail and attempts to understand it as much as possible.

As for the first group, their position is clear. They maintain this position due to the verses and Ahadith that are mentioned regarding the soul. The only verse in the Quran that directly addresses the concept of the soul is in Surah Isra.

﴿وَيَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الرُّوحِ قُلِ الرُّوحُ مِنْ أَمْرِ رَبِّي وَمَا أُوتِيتُمْ مِنَ الْعِلْمِ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا﴾ [الإسراء: 85]

«And they ask you, [O Muhammad], about the soul. Say, "The soul is of the affair of my Lord. And mankind have not been given of knowledge except a little."(85)» [Isra: 85]

This verse clearly states that the soul is something which Allah has the true knowledge of and humans cannot fully comprehend.

The second group delves more deeply into understanding the soul based on all of the textual evidences that are available regarding the soul. The most notable scholar amongst this group is the great Imam *Ibn Al-Qayyim Al-Jawziyya* in his book *Al-Rub*. In it he mentions many extensive discussions regarding the soul and the afterlife and is a resource for everyone who came after him in this discussion.

The relied upon position according to this group as mentioned by Ibn Al-Qayyim and Imam Safarini is:

أن الروح جسم مخالف بالماهية، لهذا الجسم المحسوس، وهو جسمٌ نورانيٌ علوي، خفيفٌ حي متحرك، ينفذ في جوهر الأعضاء، ويسري فيها سريان الماء في الورد، وسريان الدهن في الزيتون، والنار في الفحم، فما دامت هذه الأعضاء صالحة لقبول الآثار الفائضة عليها من هذا الجسم اللطيف، بقي ذلك الجسم اللطيف، مُشابهًا لهذه الأعضاء، وأفادها هذه الآثار من الحس والحركة الإرادية، وإذا فسدت هذه الأعضاء، بسبب استيلاء الأخلاط الغليظة عليها، وخرجت عن قبول تلك الآثار، فارق الروح البدن، وانفصل إلى عالم الأرواح

The soul is a being that is different than the physical body. It is a heavenly being made from light, it is very subtle, living, and moving. It disperses amongst the limbs of the body and flows through it as water flows through a flower or how oil flows through an olive or fire through coal. As long as these limbs are capable of accepting the effect of this soul, the soul will remain connected to the body and it gives the body the ability to feel, move, and will. If these limbs become corrupted and can no longer accept the effect of the soul, the soul separates from the body and goes to the realm of the souls.¹

It is also agreed upon by all scholars that the soul is a being which has a beginning but does not have an end. All souls were drawn out from the back of Adam (AS) and presented with belief in the oneness of Allah before the physical form of any of these souls was created. As is mentioned in the verse:

﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذَ رَبُّكَ مِنْ بَنِي آدَمَ مِنْ ظُهُورِهِمْ ذُرِّيَّتَهُمْ وَأَشْهَدَهُمْ عَلَى أَنْفُسِهِمْ أَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ قَالُوا بَلَى شَهِدْنَا أَنْ تَقُولُوا يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ إِنَّا كُنَّا عَنْ هَذَا غَافِلِينَ﴾ [الأعراف: 172]

«And [mention] when your Lord took from the children of Adam - from their loins - their descendants and made them testify of themselves, [saying to them], "Am I not your Lord?" They said, "Yes, we have

¹ *Al-Buhoor Al-Zakhiya fi Uloom Al-Akhirah*, Vol. 1, Pg.98, Dar Al-'Asima Lil-nashr Wal Tawzee', 2009

testified." [This] - lest you should say on the day of Resurrection,
"Indeed, we were of this unaware."(172)» [Al-A'raf: 172]

This is the beginning of the life of the souls to which there is no end. As is the unanimous agreement of the scholars of Ahlus Sunnah, upon the afterlife being an eternal realm.

2.2 MUSLIM OUTLOOK ON DEATH

Once it is established that the soul is a creation that does not perish, rather it simply changes states, this guides the Islamic understanding of death. Imam Ghazali mentions in *Ihya Uloom Ad-Din*, many different groups and how they viewed death. Some have seen it to be an end point, others a new beginning. In reality Muslims see death as a transition. If the true life is the life of the soul, which existed before the body and will exist after it, then death is simply a means of the soul transitioning to another stage of its life. Hence, death is seen as a relief for the believer as they can finally transition to that which they had been working for in the worldly life.

3 STAGES OF LIFE

After understanding that death is simply a means of transitioning the soul from one state to another, it should be known that after a human is born they go through 3 phases:

3.1 THE WORLDLY LIFE (عالم الدنيا)

This phase begins after 4 months of a fetus' development, after the *Ruh* enters the body. This is mentioned in the famous narration:

قَالَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ: حَدَّثَنَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ وَهُوَ الصَّادِقُ الْمَصْدُوقُ، قَالَ: «إِنَّ أَحَدَكُمْ يُجْمَعُ خَلْقُهُ فِي بَطْنِ أُمِّهِ أَرْبَعِينَ يَوْمًا، ثُمَّ يَكُونُ عَلَقَةً مِثْلَ ذَلِكَ، ثُمَّ يَكُونُ مُضْغَةً مِثْلَ ذَلِكَ، ثُمَّ يَبْعَثُ اللَّهُ مَلَكًا فَيُؤَمِّرُ بِأَرْبَعِ كَلِمَاتٍ، وَيُقَالُ لَهُ: اكْتُبْ عَمَلَهُ، وَرِزْقَهُ، وَأَجَلَهُ، وَشَقِيٌّ أَوْ سَعِيدٌ، ثُمَّ يُنْفَخُ فِيهِ الرُّوحُ، فَإِنَّ الرَّجُلَ مِنْكُمْ لَيَعْمَلُ حَتَّى مَا يَكُونُ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَ الْجَنَّةِ إِلَّا ذِرَاعٌ، فَيَسْبِقُ عَلَيْهِ كِتَابُهُ،

فَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ النَّارِ، وَيَعْمَلُ حَتَّى مَا يَكُونُ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَ النَّارِ إِلَّا ذِرَاعٌ، فَيَسْبِقُ عَلَيْهِ الْكِتَابُ،
فَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ الْجَنَّةِ²

Abdullah ibn Masood narrated:

“Allah's Messenger ﷺ the true and truly inspired, narrated to us, "The creation of every one of you starts with the process of collecting the material for his body within forty days and forty nights in the womb of his mother. Then he becomes a clot of thick blood for a similar period (40 days) and then he becomes like a piece of flesh for a similar period. Then an angel is sent to him (by Allah ﷻ) and the angel is allowed (ordered) to write four things; his livelihood, his (date of) death, his deeds, and whether he will be a wretched one or a blessed one (in the Hereafter) and then the soul is breathed into him. So one of you may do (good) deeds characteristic of the people of Paradise so much that there is nothing except a cubit between him and Paradise but then what has been written for him decides his behavior and he starts doing (evil) deeds characteristic of the people of Hell (Fire) and (ultimately) enters Hell (Fire); and one of you may do (evil) deeds characteristic of the people of Hell (Fire) so much so that there is nothing except a cubit between him and Hell (Fire), then what has been written for him decides his behavior and he starts doing (good) deeds characteristic of the people of Paradise and ultimately enters Paradise."

During this phase the body is the primary actor in all worldly aspects while the soul still plays a role. This is the realm in which individuals are given the responsibility to belief in, worship, and obey all commands of Allah to the best of one's ability. Based on one's ability to do this in this short period of time, the outcome of the next two phases is determined.

3.2 THE LIFE IN THE GRAVE (عالم البرزخ)

This phase begins when the soul leaves the body. An individual has now left the realm of responsibility (دار التكليف) and entered into the realm of compensation (دار الجزاء). At this stage the soul either goes to عليين or سجين. These are the locations of the souls of the pious or the wretched in this phase. These places are described in the verses:

² Bukhari 6614, Muslim 2652

﴿كَلَّا إِنَّ كِتَابَ الْفُجَّارِ لَفِي سِجِّينٍ﴾ [المطففين: 7]

«No! Indeed, the record of the wicked is in sijjeen(7)» [Al-Mutaffifen: 7]

﴿كَلَّا إِنَّ كِتَابَ الْأَبْرَارِ لَفِي عِلِّيِّينَ﴾ [المطففين: 18]

«No! Indeed, the record of the righteous is in 'illiyyun(18)»

[Al-Mutaffifen: 18]

In this location the soul is now the primary actor while the body still exists in a decomposing state.

Just as the physical body is in a cell of sorts in the grave, the soul is in a similar space in its location. This cell will expand for the believer and they will experience blessings from paradise.³ While this cell will become tight on a wretched person and they will experience some of the punishments of the hellfire.

In this cell the soul is given a physical representation of sorts which experiences the result of its actions. As is indicated to in the hadith regarding the souls of the martyrs:

أَرْوَاحُهُمْ فِي جَوْفِ طَيْرٍ خُضِرٍ⁴

“Their souls are in the bodies of green birds”

Just like the soul and body were connected in the worldly life, likewise they are connected in this phase. As is indicated to in the hadith regarding the martyrs:

فَإِنَّهُ لَيْسَ كَلَمٌ يُكَلَّمُ فِي اللَّهِ إِلَّا يَأْتِي يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ يَدْمَى⁵

“There is not a wound that a martyr is wounded in the path of Allah except they will come on the day of judgment bleeding”

This connection varies in strength based on the individual. The strongest connection is that of the Prophets, as is illuded to in the hadith:

³ This concept is understood by combining many narrations regarding the life of the grave which mention the experience a believer will have in the grave. While maintaining that the physical grave in which the body rests does not expand physically, nor does the physical body wear clothes from paradise as will be mentioned in chapter 6.3

⁴ Muslim, 1887

⁵ Nasa'i, 2140

عَنْ أَنَسِ بْنِ مَالِكٍ، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «أَتَيْتُ - وَفِي رِوَايَةٍ هَدَابٍ: مَرَرْتُ - عَلَى مُوسَى لَيْلَةً أُسْرِيَ بِي عِنْدَ الْكَثِيبِ الْأَحْمَرِ، وَهُوَ قَائِمٌ يُصَلِّي فِي قَبْرِهِ»⁶

Anas reported that the Prophet ﷺ said: “I passed by Musa on the night I was taken on the night journey, at the red sand dune while he was standing in prayer in his grave”⁷

The next level is that of the martyrs, as is mentioned in the Quran:

﴿وَلَا تَحْسَبَنَّ الَّذِينَ قُتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ أَمْوَاتًا بَلْ أَحْيَاءٌ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِمْ يُرْزَقُونَ ﴿١٦٩﴾ فَرِحِينَ بِمَا آتَاهُمُ اللَّهُ مِنْ فَضْلِهِ وَيَسْتَبْشِرُونَ بِالَّذِينَ لَمْ يَلْحَقُوا بِهِمْ مِنْ خَلْفِهِمْ أَلَّا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ ﴿١٧٠﴾ يَسْتَبْشِرُونَ بِنِعْمَةِ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَفَضْلٍ وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُضِيعُ أَجْرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ ﴿١٧١﴾﴾ [آل عمران: 171-169]

«And never think of those who have been killed in the cause of Allah as dead. Rather, they are alive with their Lord, receiving provision(169)

Rejoicing in what Allah has bestowed upon them of His bounty, and they receive good tidings about those [to be martyred] after them who have not yet joined them - that there will be no fear concerning them, nor will they grieve(170)

They receive good tidings of favor from Allah and bounty and [of the fact] that Allah does not allow the reward of believers to be lost(171)» [Al-i'Imran: 169-171]

The next level is the pious individuals in order of piety.

Some scholars are of the opinion that after going to عليين or سجين the soul returns to the body, thus the deceased can hear the footsteps of the people leaving the *Janaazah*. As is mentioned in the hadith:

إِنَّ الْمَيِّتَ إِذَا وُضِعَ فِي قَبْرِهِ، إِنَّهُ لَيَسْمَعُ خَفَقَ نِعَالِهِمْ إِذَا انْصَرَفُوا⁸

“When the deceased is placed in their grave, they hear the footsteps of the people as they leave.”

⁶ Muslim, 2375

⁸ Muslim, 287

Another opinion is that the experiences the soul is having can be projected into the physical grave. This is supported by the large amount of narrations and experiences people have with graves. For example, a martyrs body smiling in the grave, a good smell coming from a grave, a snake coming from a grave, etc. Some narrations will be mentioned in later chapters.

3.2.1 Do the Souls of the Deceased Interact?

This is a famous discussion in the books of Tafseer regarding the souls of the dead meeting each other as well as the souls of the dead meeting the souls of the living while they sleep. The core verse in this discussion is in Surah Zumar:

﴿اللَّهُ يَتَوَفَّى الْأَنفُسَ حِينَ مَوْتِهَا وَالَّتِي لَمْ تَمُتْ فِي مَنَامِهَا فَيُمْسِكُ الَّتِي قَضَىٰ عَلَيْهَا الْمَوْتَ وَيُرْسِلُ الْأُخْرَىٰ إِلَىٰ أَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّقَوْمٍ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ﴾ [الزمر: 42]

«Allah takes the souls at the time of their death, and those that do not die [He takes] during their sleep. Then He keeps those for which He has decreed death and releases the others for a specified term. Indeed in that are signs for a people who give thought(42)» [Az-Zumar: 42]⁹

Regarding this verse there is an authentic narration¹⁰ from Ibn Abbas رضي الله عنه in which he says:

عَنْ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ فِي هَذِهِ الْآيَةِ قَالَ بَلَغَنِي أَنَّ أَرْوَاحَ الْأَحْيَاءِ وَالْأَمْوَاتِ تَلْتَقِي فِي الْمَنَامِ فَيَتَسَاءَلُونَ بَيْنَهُمْ فَيُمْسِكُ اللَّهُ أَرْوَاحَ الْمَوْتَى وَيُرْسِلُ أَرْوَاحَ الْأَحْيَاءِ إِلَىٰ أَجْسَادِهَا

“The souls of the living and the dead meet while the living sleep and they discuss amongst themselves, then Allah holds back the souls of the dead and returns the souls of the living to their bodies.”

Regarding this concept Imam Mawardi mentions a statement of Ali رضي الله عنه in which he says:

“Whatever the soul of the individual sees while it is in the heavens before it is returned to the body is a true dream, and whatever it sees after it is returned to its body is a false dream coming from the shaytan.”

⁹ It should be noted that there are multiple interpretations for this verse, all of which have strong evidence and do not at all contradict each other, rather refer to various aspects of the souls.

¹⁰ This narration was mentioned by Imam Tabarani and Ibn Hajar Al-Haythami in Majma' Al-Zawaid in which he states that the narrators of this narration are authentic. Interestingly, even those who deny that the dead can hear the living accept this concept.

Ibn Al-Qayyim mentions this discussion in full detail in his book *Al-Rooh*. In which he states:

شواهد هذه المسألة وأدلتها أكثر من أن يحصيها إلا الله تعالى والحس والواقع من أعدل الشهود بها، فتلتقي أرواح الأحياء والأموات كما تلتقي أرواح الأحياء

“The proofs and evidences for this matter are too many to be enumerated except by Allah. Experience and testimony are the most trustworthy witnesses, hence the souls of the living and the deceased meet just as the souls of the living meet.”¹¹

3.3 THE AFTERLIFE (الآخرة)

This phase begins after resurrection. At this point all of the events of the day of judgment will occur and one will either enter paradise or hellfire. In this phase the soul and body are reunited and upon entry into paradise or hellfire the body and soul are transformed into their most complete form. This grants the ability to experience the bliss or punishment at the highest level, as the original body is very limited in its ability to experience pleasure or pain. This concept is illuded to in the Quran:

﴿كَذَلِكَ الْعَذَابُ وَلَعَذَابُ الْآخِرَةِ أَكْبَرُ لَوْ كَانُوا يَعْلَمُونَ﴾ [القلم: 33]

«Such is the punishment [of this world]. And the punishment of the Hereafter is greater, if they only knew(33)» [Al-Qalam: 33]

As well as in the Hadith:

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " ضَرْسُ الْكَافِرِ أَوْ نَابُ الْكَافِرِ مِثْلُ أُحُدٍ وَغِلْظُ جِلْدِهِ مَسِيرَةُ ثَلَاثٍ " ¹²

“The molar (or canine) of a disbeliever (in the afterlife) is the size of Mount Uhud and the thickness of their skin will be three day journey.”

This phase is not the main subject of this treatise however there are long books written regarding the detailed description of all phases of the afterlife. In summary there are few phases:¹³

1. Resurrection from the grave
2. Gathering of all people in the plain of resurrection

¹¹ Pg. 20, DKI

¹² Muslim, 2851

¹³ For an in depth discussion on these phases refer to *Al-Buhoor Al-Zakbira fi Uloom Al-Akhirah*

3. Questioning of all people
4. The weighing of deeds
5. Crossing the *Sirat*
6. The pond of *Kawthar*
7. Entering into paradise or hellfire

4 BELIEF IN THE LIFE OF THE GRAVE AND THE AFTERLIFE

The existence of the latter two stages of life are part of the creed of *Ablus Sunnah* which as Muslims we whole heartedly affirm and believe in as certainly as we believe in our existence in the worldly life.

The existence of these two stages is proven explicitly and implicitly through innumerable verses, narrations, and statements of the companions and pious predecessors. There is also the unanimous consensus of the companions, their students, and anyone who has a slight resemblance of scholarship or has a basic understanding of the fundamentals of Islam, that these stages of life are a reality which we will all experience. This will be explained in detail in the coming chapters.

It is important to understand that these types of beliefs are not reached through reasoning and observation, rather the only way these beliefs are established is through divine revelation. Just like belief in the angels, heaven, hellfire, and other aspects of the unseen world. Denying any of these aspects of the unseen which Allah ﷻ and the Prophet ﷺ have informed of is a form of rejection of Allah ﷻ and his messenger ﷺ.

It is even more abhorrent to reject these aspects of the religion based simply on whims and speculation. For if the religion is left to be determined by these types of thoughts, it is clear that different individuals are of different levels of understanding and different methods of thinking. This would leave the religion open to be altered based on what is perceived to be the most convincing argument, causing it to change drastically based on time, place, and person. In reality this is a form of undermining the religion and placing ones weak understanding above the direct command or report of Allah ﷻ and his messenger ﷺ. The approach of a believer to matters of religion should be as Allah ﷻ has commanded in the Quran:

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا آمِنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ وَالْكِتَابِ الَّذِي نَزَّلَ عَلَى رَسُولِهِ وَالْكِتَابِ الَّذِي أَنزَلَ مِنْ قَبْلُ وَمَنْ يَكْفُرْ بِاللَّهِ وَمَلَائِكَتِهِ وَكُتُبِهِ وَرُسُلِهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَقَدْ ضَلَّ ضَلَالًا بَعِيدًا﴾ [النساء: 136]

«O you who have believed, believe in Allah and His Messenger and the Book that He sent down upon His Messenger and the Scripture which He sent down before. And whoever disbelieves in Allah, His angels, His books, His messengers, and the Last Day has certainly gone far astray(136)» [An-Nisaa: 136]

﴿لَيْسَ الْبِرَّ أَنْ تُوَلُّوا وُجُوهَكُمْ قِبَلَ الْمَشْرِقِ وَالْمَغْرِبِ وَلَكِنَّ الْبِرَّ مَنْ آمَنَ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةِ وَالْكِتَابِ وَالنَّبِيِّينَ وَآتَى الْمَالَ عَلَى حُبِّهِ ذَوِي الْقُرْبَى وَالْيَتَامَى وَالْمَسَاكِينَ وَابْنَ السَّبِيلِ وَالسَّائِلِينَ وَفِي الرِّقَابِ وَأَقَامَ الصَّلَاةَ وَآتَى الزَّكَاةَ وَالْمُوفُونَ بِعَهْدِهِمْ إِذَا عَاهَدُوا وَالصَّابِرِينَ فِي الْبَأْسَاءِ وَالضَّرَّاءِ وَحِينَ الْبَأْسِ أُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ صَدَقُوا وَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُتَّقُونَ ﴿١٧٧﴾﴾ [البقرة: 177]

«Righteousness is not that you turn your faces toward the east or the west, but [true] righteousness is [in] one who believes in Allah, the Last Day, the angels, the Book, and the prophets and gives wealth, in spite of love for it, to relatives, orphans, the needy, the traveler, those who ask [for help], and for freeing slaves; [and who] establishes prayer and gives zakah; [those who] fulfill their promise when they promise; and [those who] are patient in poverty and hardship and during battle. Those are the ones who have been true, and it is those who are the righteous(177)» [Al-Baqara: 177]¹⁴

﴿قُلْ إِنَّمَا حَرَّمَ رَبِّي الْفَوَاحِشَ مَا ظَهَرَ مِنْهَا وَمَا بَطَنَ وَالْإِثْمَ وَالْبَغْيَ بِغَيْرِ الْحَقِّ وَأَنْ تُشْرِكُوا بِاللَّهِ مَا لَمْ يُنْزَلْ بِهِ سُلْطَانًا وَأَنْ تَقُولُوا عَلَى اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٣٣﴾﴾ [الأعراف: 33]

«Say, "My Lord has only forbidden immoralities - what is apparent of them and what is concealed - and sin, and oppression without right, and that you associate with Allah that for which He has not sent down authority, and that you say about Allah that which you do not know."(33)» [Al-A'raf: 33]¹⁵

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَقْدِمُوا بَيْنَ يَدَيِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ ﴿١﴾﴾ [الحجرات: 1]

¹⁴ This is one of the most powerful passages in understanding the importance of submission and obedience to Allah ﷻ. This verse was revealed when the Jews were rejecting the re-direction of the *Qiblah* from Jerusalem to Mecca. Logically, based on all previous prophets facing Jerusalem, this prophet should be no different. However, Allah ﷻ is making it clear that the only reason any action is done is because of His command. The only reason an act of worship is valid is because it is performed in the way He commanded. If an individual is to base what parts of the scripture and what commands they accept based on that which makes sense to them, this individual is falling into the same grave error that the Jews fell into in many situations.

¹⁵ In this verse Allah ﷻ lists major sins in ascending order, the final sin listed here is speaking about Allah ﷻ without knowledge. This shows the magnitude of this crime which many pseudo-intellectuals, laymen, and so-called scholars commit every day. The people of true piety and God-consciousness are very cautious while speaking about matters of religion.

«O you who have believed, do not put [yourselves] before Allah and His Messenger but fear Allah. Indeed, Allah is Hearing and Knowing(1)» [Al-Hujurat: 1]

﴿فَلَا وَرَبِّكَ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ حَتَّى يُحَكِّمُوكَ فِيمَا شَجَرَ بَيْنَهُمْ ثُمَّ لَا يَجِدُوا فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ حَرَجًا مِمَّا قَضَيْتَ وَيُسَلِّمُوا تَسْلِيمًا﴾ [النساء: 65]

«But no, by your Lord, they will not [truly] believe until they make you, [O Muhammad], judge concerning that over which they dispute among themselves and then find within themselves no discomfort from what you have judged and submit in [full, willing] submission(65)» [An-Nisaa: 65]¹⁶

And what the Prophet ﷺ said:

وَعَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «كَفَى بِالْمَرْءِ كَذِبًا أَنْ يُحَدِّثَ بِكُلِّ مَا سَمِعَ». رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ¹⁷

“It is enough to lie for an individual to relate everything they hear.”¹⁸

وَعَنْ أَبِي رَافِعٍ وَغَيْرِهِ رَفَعَهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «لَا أَلْفَيْنَ أَحَدَكُمْ مُتَكِنًا عَلَى أَرِيكَتِهِ يَأْتِيهِ أَمْرٌ مِمَّا أَمَرْتُ بِهِ أَوْ نَهَيْتُ عَنْهُ فَيَقُولُ لَا أَذْرِي مَا وَجَدْنَا فِي كِتَابِ اللَّهِ اتَّبَعْنَاهُ».¹⁹

“May I not find any of you reclining on their sofa, when a matter I have commanded or prohibited comes to him and he says: ‘I don’t know, whatever we find in the book of Allah we follow it.’”²⁰

وَعَنْ أَبِي أُمَامَةَ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «مَا ضَلَّ قَوْمٌ بَعْدَ هُدًى كَانُوا عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا أُوْتُوا الْجَدَلَ». ثُمَّ قَرَأَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ هَذِهِ الْآيَةَ: (مَا ضَرَبُوهُ لَكَ إِلَّا جَدَلًا بَلْ هُمْ قَوْمٌ خَصْمُونَ)²¹

¹⁶ In this verse Allah ﷻ not only made following Him and the Prophet ﷺ a condition of true faith, rather He added that one must also be content with their decree. Meaning one should not find any doubt or ill feeling toward the tenants of the religion.

¹⁷ Muslim, 5

¹⁸ In this hadith there is warning against simply narrating everything that an individual hears, due to the likelihood that they will hear something that is not true and narrate it. If this is the case of simply narrating, then how severe would it be for an individual to entirely fabricate concepts and rulings from their own imagination and impose them on the religion of Allah ﷻ.

¹⁹ Tirmidhi, 2663

²⁰ The way this hadith describes this individual is that they are not even truly involved in religious academia in any way. Rather they are a lay person sitting in comfort denying the Prophet ﷺ while disguising themselves behind the banner of the Quran.

²¹ Tirmidhi, 3253

“A people did not go astray after being upon guidance except they were involved in argumentation.” Then the Prophet ﷺ recited the verse, “They did not present the comparison except for [mere] argument. But, [in fact], they are a people prone to dispute” [Az-Zukhruf: 58]²²

4.1 IMPORTANCE OF SEEKING AUTHENTIC KNOWLEDGE

Based on these sources, it is first and foremost the responsibility of the Muslim to seek out authentic and trustworthy knowledge as it has been preserved and passed down by the noble scholars of this religion. It is also the responsibility of every individual to implement and follow the information they receive from these sources. In regards to seeking knowledge an individual there are 3 main levels of people:

1. Those who have a trusted and pious scholar²³ whom they refer to and take knowledge from when they have questions. They take what they give them at face value and do not do independent investigation and questioning. Individuals who are in this avenue are often those who are too occupied to dedicate a large amount of time to studying and learning. This is not a blameworthy thing, rather an individual having concern for what Allah ﷻ has commanded is praiseworthy. What is blameworthy is an individual who refuses to dedicate time to learning and attempts to overstep their bounds and give verdicts based on their own opinion.
2. Those who study a specific science with a skilled teacher. At this point an individual can rely upon the information they have studied in that subject. This individual is limited to the things that they studied and cannot make decisions regarding things they haven't studied directly with a teacher. In this stage an individual must refer to an expert in the field if they come across something they have not studied in depth with a teacher. If one reaches a high level in this system, and their teachers and scholars of that time attest to their eligibility, they can have some

²² This hadith prohibits involvement in useless argumentation and cites it as a factor in the deviation of a people. Many of the discussions regarding religion can easily fall into this category if they are not based on sound knowledge and connection to the scholarly tradition of Islam.

²³ It is of the utmost importance for anyone seeking out a source of Islamic knowledge to be thorough and careful in who they choose to learn the religion from. As many of the companions advised, this knowledge governs every aspect of ones life, so look carefully to those you take this knowledge from.

authority to sort through different positions and assert one. This position is typically held by the high caliber scholars of a generation.

3. Those who dedicate their lives to studying and learning until they reach a point in which they have mastered all sciences of the religion. At this point an individual can give verdicts on new situations and use their knowledge of the principles of the religion along with their knowledge of precedent in order to give verdicts. This is a point where very few individuals of each generation reach. Most students of knowledge and scholars do not surpass the second level.²⁴

It is of the upmost importance that one finds themselves in one of these stages²⁵, in order to be in compliance with the statements of many of the companions and their students:

1. قَالَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ: «اغْدُ عَالِمًا أَوْ مُتَعَلِّمًا وَلَا تَغْدُ إِمَامَةً بَيْنَ ذَلِكَ» قَالَ أَبُو يُوسُفَ، قَالَ أَهْلُ الْعِلْمِ: «الْإِمَامَةُ أَهْلُ الرَّأْيِ»²⁶
2. أَنَّ عَوْنَ بْنَ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ، قَالَ: حَدَّثْتُ عُمَرَ بْنَ عَبْدِ الْعَزِيزِ: "أَنَّهُ كَانَ يُقَالُ: «إِنْ اسْتَطَعْتَ فَكُنْ عَالِمًا فَإِنْ لَمْ تَسْتَطِعْ فَكُنْ مُتَعَلِّمًا، وَإِنْ لَمْ تَسْتَطِعْ فَأَجِبهُمْ، وَإِنْ لَمْ تَسْتَطِعْ فَلَا تَبْغِضْهُمْ» فَقَالَ عُمَرُ بْنُ عَبْدِ الْعَزِيزِ: «لَقَدْ جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لَهُ مَخْرَجًا إِنْ قِيلَ»²⁷
3. عَنِ الْحَسَنِ قَالَ: «اغْدُ عَالِمًا أَوْ مُتَعَلِّمًا، أَوْ مُسْتَمِعًا وَلَا تَكُنْ رَابِعًا فَتَهْلِكُ»²⁸
4. عَنِ الْحَسَنِ، أَنَّ أَبَا الدَّرْدَاءِ، قَالَ: «كُنْ عَالِمًا أَوْ مُتَعَلِّمًا، أَوْ مُحِبًّا أَوْ مُتَبِعًا، وَلَا تَكُنِ الْخَامِسَ فَتَهْلِكُ» قَالَ: قُلْتُ لِلْحَسَنِ: وَمَا الْخَامِسُ؟ قَالَ: الْمُبْتَدِعُ²⁹
5. عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «اغْدُ عَالِمًا أَوْ مُتَعَلِّمًا أَوْ مُسْتَمِعًا أَوْ مُحِبًّا، وَلَا تَكُنِ الْخَامِسَةَ فَتَهْلِكُ»³⁰

In these statements these companions and their students advise to either be a scholar, a student, one who attends gatherings but is not a full-time student, or one who loves

²⁴ For more details on this topic refer to: 'Iqd Al-Jeed Fi Ahkam Al-Ijtihad Wal-Taqlid by Imam Shah Waliullah Dihlawi

²⁵ It should be noted that not everyone fits into one stage entirely, rather many individuals growing in knowledge find themselves in between the first two stages. It is always better to ask a trusted teacher a question even regarding a subject you may have already studied.

²⁶Jami' Bayan Al-'Ilm Wa Fadlihi, 145

²⁷ Ibid, 143

²⁸ Ibid, 144

²⁹ Ibid, 142

³⁰ Ibid, 151

these people. They warn against being in any category outside of these four. In the first narration, Abdullah ibn Mas'oud رضي الله عنه warns against being amongst those individuals who rely purely on their reasoning and disregard the text. In the second narration, it is mentioned that if you are not in any of these four categories, ensure that you do not hate those in these groups.

4.2 DENIAL OF THE LIFE OF THE GRAVE

Denial of the life of the grave is not a new concept, contrary to what many pseudo-intellectuals make it seem. In reality these individuals are transmitting the arguments of deviant groups from hundreds of years ago while simply rebranding and redressing their arguments. It is laughable to see that many of the arguments used by innovators of today are so academically dishonest that even many of the individuals who supported this innovation in past generations would reject them.

Among the most infamous groups which adopted this deviation are some groups of the *Mu'tazila*, *Shi'a*, Kharijites, as well as hadith deniers. In reality, this belief is very similar to the belief of the pagans of Mecca when they denied resurrection based on their mere whims. The Quran describes their denial in many places, among them is:

﴿وَضَرَبَ لَنَا مَثَلًا وَنَسِيَ خَلْقَهُ قَالَ مَنْ يُحْيِي الْعِظَامَ وَهِيَ رَمِيمٌ ۗ قُلْ يُحْيِيهَا الَّذِي أَنْشَأَهَا أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ وَهُوَ بِكُلِّ خَلْقٍ عَلِيمٌ﴾ [يس: 78-79]

«And he presents for Us an example and forgets his [own] creation. He says, "Who will give life to bones while they are disintegrated?"(78)

Say, "He will give them life who produced them the first time; and He is, of all creation, Knowing."(79)» [Ya-Sin: 78-79]

Those who deny this tenant of Islamic creed based on their limited understanding which leads them to see it as impossible or improbable, are opening the door to denial of all aspects of the unseen. For a true Muslim knows that nothing is impossible for Allah, rather nothing is even difficult for Him. Furthermore if an individual believes that Allah is capable of creating the entire universe and taking his creation into account, in what way is it unrealistic that He can give them a form of life in the grave.

4.3 THE BELIEF IN THE UNSEEN

The belief in the unseen is the most fundamental belief that Muslims hold. It is the first description of a believer that Allah mentions in the Quran and is the foundation upon which all beliefs are built. Belief in the unseen entails belief in Allah, the

messengers, the books, the angels, heaven and hellfire, and many other core beliefs of Islam. These items are connected to the unseen in one way or another and an individual may never know the true reality of these things in this world.

4.3.1 Ideological Warfare

In modern times there is a great tribulation of empiricism³¹ and scientism sweeping the world. Muslims and non-Muslims alike are constantly being bombarded with these ideologies throughout every aspect of life, whether they realize or not. In the modern world, ideological warfare is the most dangerous and prevalent form of conquest. In the past century, the development of communication technology has placed anyone with internet access at point blank range in this ideological war. An individual is exposed to hundreds of ideas and philosophies a day while completely unaware. This is why these attacks are so dangerous, if one knows the enemy, they can recognize him and are not open to approaching him. However, the enemy is now camouflaged into every aspect of daily life, and the attacks are almost entirely undetectable until it is too late. This leaves an individual vulnerable and under attack for years and years before the wounds become apparent. By this time it is too late, once an idea is sown into an individual's mind for years and years, they begin to reach conclusions and base their assumptions on that idea. All without thinking critically about these ideas and whether they are sound or not.

With this being the nature of the battle, it is not surprising that the casualties are so high. Yet, many who have lost relatives to this battle are shocked by the casualty, unaware that they were being thrown into battle without armor for years. The reaction of "I don't know where this came from" is all-too common. It is also common for smaller wounds to manifest while the finishing blow was already dealt. One may only be saying that they have doubts about a certain aspect of religion while in fact they have completely apostatized mentally. When approaching the concept of religion or specific beliefs this reality must be kept in mind. What is certainly the most crushing part of this war is that the casualties do not perish, rather they often take up arms with the enemy and wage war on their own families and friends. Propagating the very ideas that destroyed them.

Once it is known that this war is waging and what tactics the enemy is using it becomes clear as day, and one can't go a few hours without being reminded they are

³¹ Empiricism is the belief that the only source of knowledge is through sensory experiences. It was developed in the 17th century and was championed and further developed by some of the founding fathers of liberal thought.

in a warzone. After being aware of this war it is necessary to arm oneself with the necessary equipment. If one can trace a statement or action back to its original philosophy, then understand the roots of that philosophy, the battle becomes very simple. As one realizes that all of the enemy combatants have the same fatal flaw. All of these ideologies are man-made. These manufactured ideas can never hold a candle to the reality of divine revelation. For in accordance to the nature of humans, the founders of these ideas had their own interests in mind. They were not developed to raise the quality of life for every being in existence. Rather they have tangible, identifiable biases and goals that benefit a certain group of individuals.

The above discussion can be applied to any ideology, philosophy, political group, movement, cult, or even members of a religion. If it is found that the members of this religion are using their religion as a cloak to disguise their true motives and intentions, a so called “religious” group can be a blood-thirsty enemy. This enemy is even more dangerous, as those who are taken advantage of by individuals disguising themselves through religion can often have a skewed outlook on religion as a whole for the rest of their lives, and pass this down to future generations. For this reason there is such a stern warning in Quran and Hadith regarding using the religion to obtain some worldly benefit, as mentioned in the verses:

﴿وَأْمِنُوا بِمَا أُنزِلْتُ مُصَدِّقًا لِّمَا مَعَكُمْ وَلَا تَكُونُوا أَوَّلَ كَافِرٍ بِهِ وَلَا تَشْتَرُوا بِآيَاتِي ثَمَنًا قَلِيلًا وَإِيَّايَ فَاتَّقُونِ﴾ [البقرة: 41]

«And believe in what I have sent down confirming that which is [already] with you, and be not the first to disbelieve in it. And do not exchange My signs for a small price, and fear [only] Me(41)» [Al-Baqara: 41]

﴿قَوْلِيلٌ لِلَّذِينَ يَكْتُمُونَ الْكِتَابَ بِأَيْدِيهِمْ ثُمَّ يَقُولُونَ هَذَا مِنْ عِنْدِ اللَّهِ لِيَشْتَرُوا بِهِ ثَمَنًا قَلِيلًا قَوْلِيلٌ لَهُمْ مِمَّا كَتَبَتْ أَيْدِيهِمْ وَوَيْلٌ لَهُمْ مِمَّا يَكْسِبُونَ﴾ [البقرة: 79]

«So woe to those who write the "scripture" with their own hands, then say, "This is from Allah," in order to exchange it for a small price. Woe to them for what their hands have written and woe to them for what they earn(79)» [Al-Baqara: 79]

﴿إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَكْتُمُونَ مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ وَيَشْتَرُونَ بِهِ ثَمَنًا قَلِيلًا أُولَٰئِكَ مَا يَأْكُلُونَ فِي بُطُونِهِمْ إِلَّا النَّارَ وَلَا يُكَلِّمُهُمُ اللَّهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ وَلَا يُزَكِّيهِمْ وَلَهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ﴾ [البقرة: 174]

«Indeed, they who conceal what Allah has sent down of the Book and exchange it for a small price - those consume not into their bellies except the Fire. And Allah will not speak to them on the Day of Resurrection,

nor will He purify them. And they will have a painful punishment(174)»
[Al-Baqara: 174]

﴿إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَشْتَرُونَ بِعَهْدِ اللَّهِ وَأَيْمَانِهِمْ ثَمَنًا قَلِيلًا أُولَٰئِكَ لَا خَلَاقَ لَهُمْ فِي الْآخِرَةِ وَلَا يُكَلِّمُهُمُ اللَّهُ وَلَا يَنْظُرُ
إِلَيْهِمْ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ وَلَا يَزَكِّيهِمْ وَلَهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ﴾ [آل عمران: 77]

«Indeed, those who exchange the covenant of Allah and their [own] oaths for a small price will have no share in the Hereafter, and Allah will not speak to them or look at them on the Day of Resurrection, nor will He purify them; and they will have a painful punishment(77)» [Al-i'Imran: 77]

In summary, there are essentially three reasons that people can fall into this monumental error of denying aspects of the unseen:

1. Sheer ignorance³² and neglecting to seek out authentic knowledge.
2. A form of pride and arrogance which leads them to place their intellect above the clear text of Quran and Hadith.
3. Pure hatred of Islam and in an attempt to mislead and confuse Muslims.

Any of these three can be consequences of the ideological warfare that nearly every Muslim is experiencing every day. Finally, it is the responsibility of every Muslim to be properly equipped to deal with these ideologies at least at a basic level. Here are eight simple points to keep in mind when faced with different ideologies.

1. The universe must necessarily have one creator
2. It does not befit a creator to leave the creation without instruction
3. If an individual claims to have received instruction they must bring proof through miracles
4. It is necessary that this individual is truthful, and morally upright
5. Any information this individual transmits regarding the creator is accepted and obeyed unconditionally.
 - a. The creator is the only one who knows the true purpose of the creation.

³² Scholars have divided ignorance into two categories: simple and compound ignorance. Simple ignorance is simply the lack of knowledge, this can easily be removed by being presented the correct information. However, compound ignorance is when an individual not only does not have knowledge regarding a topic, they are unaware of the fact that they do not have knowledge. This may give an individual the false impression that they understand a concept, resulting in confidence to speak on a topic they are not qualified too. This type of ignorance is extremely dangerous and blameworthy, while the first is entirely normal and inevitable for even the most pious and learned scholars.

- b. It is in the creations best interest to follow any instruction given by the creator
6. The lifestyle and belief system developed through this process is perfect and flawless just as its designer is.
7. Any man-made lifestyle or belief system will be inherently flawed.
 - a. Due to direct contradiction of the true divine system as well as due to the flawed nature of its designer.
8. It is in our best interest to follow the flawless lifestyle and belief system, whether we understand every aspect of it or not.

Each point requires a great deal of elaboration, however this is a basic framework to operate within. May Allah ﷻ protect this *Ummah* from any form of these tribulations.

4.4 EVIDENCE FROM THE QURAN AFFIRMING THE LIFE OF THE GRAVE

There are many verse of the Quran which affirm the life of the grave, although even one verse is more than sufficient for a true believer. The following are 19 verses that scholars of *Tafseer* have explained to refer to the life of the grave.

1. ﴿لَعَلِّي أَعْمَلُ صَالِحًا فِيمَا تَرَكْتُ كَلَّا إِنَّهَا كَلِمَةٌ هُوَ قَائِلُهَا وَمِنْ وَرَائِهِمْ بَرْزَخٌ إِلَى يَوْمِ يُبْعَثُونَ﴾ [المؤمنون: 100]

«That I might do righteousness in that which I left behind." No! It is only a word he is saying; and behind them is a barrier until the Day they are resurrected(100)» [Al-Muminun: 100]³³

2. ﴿الَّذِينَ يُعْرِضُونَ عَلَيْهَا غَُدُوءًا وَعَشِيًّا وَيَوْمَ تَقُومُ السَّاعَةُ أَدْخِلُوا آلَ فِرْعَوْنَ أَشَدَّ الْعَذَابِ﴾ [غافر: 46]

«The Fire, they are exposed to it morning and evening. And the Day the Hour appears [it will be said], "Make the people of Pharaoh enter the severest punishment."(46)» [Al-Mu'min: 46]³⁴

³³ This is the only verse in the Quran in which the word *Barzakh* is used directly referring to the life of the grave. In Arabic this word originally refers to a barrier. Hence the life of the grave is referred to using this word as it is a barrier between an individual and the hereafter or a barrier between an individual and the worldly life.

³⁴ This verse is explicit in that there will be a punishment before the day of judgment. Scholars of *Tafseer* have varying opinions regarding the details of this based on the varying narrations. *Imam Mawardi* summarizes the 3 main opinions:

1. They are shown their abodes in hellfire day and night. *Qatadah* mentioned this opinion.
2. Their souls are placed in the bodies of black birds which present themselves before the hellfire day and night. *Ibn Masoud* mentioned this opinion.
3. They are punished in their graves day and night. *Mujahid* mentioned this opinion.

3. ﴿وَمِمَّنْ حَوْلَكُم مِّنَ الْأَعْرَابِ مُنَافِقُونَ وَمِنْ أَهْلِ الْمَدِينَةِ مَرَدُّوا عَلَى التِّقَاقِ لَا تَعْلَمُهُمْ خَنَّ تَعْلَمُهُمْ سَنُعَذِّبُهُمْ مَّرَّتَيْنِ ثُمَّ يُرَدُّونَ إِلَىٰ عَذَابٍ عَظِيمٍ﴾ [التوبة: 101]

«And among those around you of the bedouins are hypocrites, and [also] from the people of Madinah. They have become accustomed to hypocrisy. You, [O Muhammad], do not know them, [but] We know them. We will punish them twice; then they will be returned to a great punishment(101)» [At-Tauba: 101]³⁵

4. ﴿وَلَا تَقُولُوا لِمَن يُقْتَلُ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ أَمْوَاتٌ بَلْ أَحْيَاءٌ وَلَكِن لَّا تَشْعُرُونَ﴾ [البقرة: 154]

«And do not say about those who are killed in the way of Allah, "They are dead." Rather, they are alive, but you perceive [it] not(154)» [Al-Baqara: 154]

5. ﴿وَلَا تَحْسَبَنَّ الَّذِينَ قُتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ أَمْوَاتًا بَلْ أَحْيَاءٌ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِمْ يُرْزَقُونَ﴾ [آل عمران: 169]

«And never think of those who have been killed in the cause of Allah as dead. Rather, they are alive with their Lord, receiving provision(169)» [Al-i'Imran: 169]³⁶

6. ﴿مِمَّا خَطِيئَاتِهِمْ أُغْرِقُوا فَأُدْخِلُوا نَارًا فَلَمْ يَجِدُوا لَهُمْ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ أَنْصَارًا﴾ [نوح: 25]

«Because of their sins they were drowned and put into the Fire, and they found not for themselves besides Allah [any] helpers(25)» [Nuh: 25]³⁷

7. ﴿يُنَبِّئُ اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا بِالْقَوْلِ الثَّابِتِ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ وَيُضِلُّ اللَّهُ الظَّالِمِينَ وَيَفْعَلُ اللَّهُ مَا يَشَاءُ﴾ [إبراهيم: 27]

³⁵ In this verse it is mentioned that these individuals will be punished twice before the great punishment. The scholars of *Tafseer* mention different interpretations of these two punishments. Some have mentioned that the first is in the worldly life through embarrassment, or at the time of death when the soul is extracted harshly by the angels. The second punishment is that of the grave. The third punishment which is referred to as the great punishment is the final punishment of the hellfire.

³⁶ These verses clearly states that martyrs are not dead, rather alive with their Lord. The meaning of this life cannot be in the worldly life, nor in the afterlife as mentioned previously. Therefore, this must refer to the stage of the life of the grave.

³⁷ This verse indicates to the punishment of the grave due to the letter ف being used to describe their entrance into the fire. This letter indicates that their punishment took place immediately after they were drowned. Secondly, the verb is in the past tense which would indicate that this punishment already took place, and it is known that nobody will enter into the hellfire until the day of judgment. Therefore, this must be a different type of punishment. For a more detailed discussion, refer to the explanation of this verse in *Tafseer Al-Razi*, Nasafi, and Baydawi. It should be noted that a large number of scholars have interpreted this verse to refer to either the punishment of the afterlife, or a punishment they received in this world after drowning. However, this interpretation is entirely acceptable and is the position of many scholars.

«Allah keeps firm those who believe, with the firm word, in worldly life and in the Hereafter. And Allah sends astray the wrongdoers. And Allah does what He wills(27)» [Ibrahim: 27]³⁸

8. ﴿قَالُوا رَبَّنَا أَمَتَّنَا اثْنَتَيْنِ وَأَحْيَيْتَنَا اثْنَتَيْنِ فَاعْتَرَفْنَا بِذُنُوبِنَا فَهَلْ إِلَى خُرُوجٍ مِنْ سَبِيلٍ﴾ [غافر: 11]

«They will say, "Our Lord, You made us lifeless twice and gave us life twice, and we have confessed our sins. So is there to an exit any way?"(11)» [Al-Mu'min: 11]³⁹

9. ﴿كَيْفَ تَكْفُرُونَ بِاللَّهِ وَكُنْتُمْ أَمْوَاتًا فَأَحْيَاكُمْ ثُمَّ يُمَيِّتُكُمْ ثُمَّ يُحْيِيكُمْ ثُمَّ إِلَيْهِ تُرْجَعُونَ﴾ [البقرة: 28]

«How can you disbelieve in Allah when you were lifeless and He brought you to life; then He will cause you to die, then He will bring you [back] to life, and then to Him you will be returned(28)» [Al-Baqara: 28]

10. ﴿... وَلَوْ تَرَى إِذِ الظَّالِمُونَ فِي غَمَرَاتِ الْمَوْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ بَاسِطُو أَيْدِيهِمْ أَخْرِجُوا أَنْفُسَكُمُ الْيَوْمَ تُجْزَوْنَ عَذَابَ الْهُونِ بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَقُولُونَ عَلَى اللَّهِ غَيْرَ الْحَقِّ وَكُنْتُمْ عَنْ آيَاتِهِ تَسْتَكْبِرُونَ﴾ [الأنعام: 93]

«... And if you could but see when the wrongdoers are in the overwhelming pangs of death while the angels extend their hands, [saying], "Discharge your souls! Today you will be awarded the punishment of [extreme] humiliation for what you used to say against Allah other than the truth and [that] you were, toward His verses, being arrogant."(93)» [Al-An'am: 93]⁴⁰

11. ﴿وَلَنَذِقَنَّهُمْ مِنَ الْعَذَابِ الْأَدْنَى دُونَ الْعَذَابِ الْأَكْبَرِ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْجِعُونَ﴾ [السجدة: 21]

«And we will surely let them taste the nearer punishment short of the greater punishment that perhaps they will repent(21)» [As-Sajda: 21]⁴¹

³⁸ This verse was interpreted by the Prophet ﷺ himself to refer to the punishment of the grave as is mentioned in the fifth narration of the next chapter.

³⁹ The scholars of *Tafseer* differed regarding the details of the two periods of lifelessness and the two periods of life. In summary, some have mentioned that the first life and the first death are that of the worldly life. The second life is the life in the grave, and the second death is the death everyone will experience when the horn is blown. One may claim that this view leaves out the afterlife, meaning there should be 3 lives. Some scholars have responded that the life of the afterlife is not followed by death. Therefore, it differs from the normal understanding of life, hence was excluded from this 4 stages. Verse number 8 in this list supports the meaning of this understanding.

⁴⁰ This verse indicates that immediately after death there is punishment, this is understood by the angels saying: "Today you will be awarded..."

⁴¹ The scholars of *Tafseer* have differed regarding the meaning of "The nearer punishment". The overwhelming majority mentions that this refers to difficulties in the worldly life, while some scholars specify calamities that this may be referring to, others left it general. Some scholars such as *Mujahid* included the punishment of the grave in the understanding of this verse along with the worldly difficulties. Refer to *Al-Durr Al-Manthoor* of *Al-Sayuti*.

12. ﴿وَإِنَّ لِلَّذِينَ ظَلَمُوا عَذَابًا دُونَ ذَلِكَ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَهُمْ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ﴾ [الطور: 47]

«And indeed, for those who have wronged is a punishment before that, but most of them do not know(47)» [At-Tur: 47]⁴²

13. ﴿وَمَنْ أَعْرَضَ عَنْ ذِكْرِي فَإِنَّ لَهُ مَعِيشَةً ضَنْكًا وَنَحْشُرُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ أَعْمَى﴾ [طه: 124]

«And whoever turns away from My remembrance - indeed, he will have a depressed life, and We will gather him on the Day of Resurrection blind."(124)» [Ta-ha: 124]⁴³

14. ﴿الَّذِينَ تَتَوَفَّاهُمُ الْمَلَائِكَةُ طَيِّبِينَ يَقُولُونَ سَلَامٌ عَلَيْكُمْ ادْخُلُوا الْجَنَّةَ بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ﴾ [النحل: 32]

«The ones whom the angels take in death, [being] good and pure; [the angels] will say, "Peace be upon you. Enter Paradise for what you used to do."(32)» [An-Nahl: 32]⁴⁴

15. ﴿إِنَّ الَّذِينَ كَذَّبُوا بِآيَاتِنَا وَاسْتَكْبَرُوا عَنْهَا لَا تُفَتَّحُ لَهُمْ أَبْوَابُ السَّمَاءِ وَلَا يَدْخُلُونَ الْجَنَّةَ حَتَّى يَلِجَ الْجَمَلُ فِي سَمِّ الْخِيَاطِ وَكَذَلِكَ نَجْزِي الْمُجْرِمِينَ﴾ [الأعراف: 40]

«Indeed, those who deny Our verses and are arrogant toward them - the gates of Heaven will not be opened for them, nor will they enter Paradise until a camel enters into the eye of a needle. And thus do We recompense the criminals(40)» [Al-A'raf: 40]⁴⁵

16. ﴿أَلْهَاكُمْ التَّكَاثُرُ ۚ حَتَّى زُرْتُمُ الْمَقَابِرَ ۚ كَلَّا سَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ ۚ ثُمَّ كَلَّا سَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ ۚ﴾ [التكاثر: 1-4]

«Competition in [worldly] increase diverts you(1)
Until you visit the graveyards(2)
No! You are going to know(3)
Then no! You are going to know(4)» [At-Takathur: 1-4]⁴⁶

⁴² This verse supports the meaning mentioned in the previous verse with similar wording being used.

⁴³ There are many narrations in which the Prophet ﷺ, the companions, and their students have interpreted this "Depressed Life" as the punishment of the grave. Refer to *Al-Durr Al-Manthoor* of *Al-Suyuti*.

⁴⁴ Many scholars of *Tafseer* have stated that this refers to the reward the believers receive in the grave. The statement of the angels is understood as a glad tidings, meaning they are congratulating them upon something that will soon happen due to their actions. Refer to *Tafseer Al-Razi*.

⁴⁵ This verse is understood in light of the long narration regarding the life of the grave in which it is mentioned that the souls of the deceased rise up through the heavens. The doors of the heavens are opened for the pious souls as they continue to ascend. While they are not opened for the wretched souls and they are thrown down to lowest earth. This entire process takes place in the life of the grave. Refer to *Al-Durr Al-Manthoor* of *Al-Suyuti*.

⁴⁶ Ibn Abbas and others have explained that verse number 3 refers to the life of the grave. See *Tafseer Ibn Kathir*.

17. ﴿فَلَوْلَا إِذَا بَلَغَتِ الْحُلُقُومَ﴾ [الواقعة: 83]

«Then why, when the soul at death reaches the throat(83)» [Al-Waqia: 83]⁴⁷

Until the end of Surah Waqiah.

18. ﴿كَلَّا إِنَّ كِتَابَ الْفُجَّارِ لَفِي سِجِّينَ﴾ [المطففين: 7]

«No! Indeed, the record of the wicked is in sijjeen(7)» [Al-Mutaffifen: 7]

﴿كَلَّا إِنَّ كِتَابَ الْأَبْرَارِ لَفِي عِلِّيَّينَ﴾ [المطففين: 18]

«No! Indeed, the record of the righteous is in 'illiyyun(18)»
[Al-Mutaffifen: 18]⁴⁸

19. ﴿وَقُلْ اْعْمَلُوا فَسَيَرَى اللَّهُ عَمَلَكُمْ وَرَسُولُهُ وَالْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَسَتُرَدُّونَ إِلَىٰ عَالِمِ الْغَيْبِ وَالشَّهَادَةِ فَيُنَبِّئُكُم بِمَا كُنتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ﴾ [التوبة: 105]

«And say, "Do [as you will], for Allah will see your deeds, and [so, will] His Messenger and the believers. And you will be returned to the Knower of the unseen and the witnessed, and He will inform you of what you used to do."(105)» [At-Tauba: 105]⁴⁹

4.5 EVIDENCE FROM HADITH AFFIRMING THE LIFE OF THE GRAVE

Imam Taftazani states in his commentary on *Al-Aqa'id Al-Nasafiya*:

The narrations regarding this topic, along with many stations of the afterlife, have collectively reached the level of *Tawatur*⁵⁰, although the individual narrations may not reach this level.⁵¹

I will suffice upon 10 authentic narrations, although there are dozens if not hundreds of narrations explicitly and implicitly affirming the life of the grave.

⁴⁷ These verses describe the state of three types of individuals when the soul is leaving the body and the state immediately after. See Tafseer Ibn Kathir and Razi

⁴⁸ These two verses mention the names of the locations of the souls of the believers and disbelievers after they pass away. See Tafseer Ibn Kathir

⁴⁹ Ibn Kathir has mentioned under the Tafseer of this verse that are many narrations that mention the deeds of the living being presented to their deceased family members. He then mentioned multiple narrations supporting this concept.

⁵⁰ This is a term in the sciences of hadith which describes a narration narrated by such a large number of people it is impossible for all of them to have cooperated in fabricating the narration. Narrations with this number of narrators are the strongest type of narration in hadith sciences and they are just as firmly established as a verse of the Quran.

⁵¹ Pg. 258, Maktabatu Al-Bushra, 2018

1. حَدَّثَنَا عَلِيُّ بْنُ أَبِي طَالِبٍ ، قَالَ: كُنَّا مَعَ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ يَوْمَ الْحَنْدَقِ، فَقَالَ: «مَلَأَ اللَّهُ قُبُورَهُمْ وَيُؤْتِيَهُمْ نَارًا، كَمَا شَعَلُونَا عَنْ صَلَاةِ الْوُسْطَى حَتَّى غَابَتِ الشَّمْسُ» وَهِيَ صَلَاةُ الْعَصْرِ⁵²

Ali ibn Abi Talib narrated: “We were with the Prophet ﷺ on the day of the battle of the trench when he said: “**May Allah fill their graves and their homes with fire**, they have occupied us from the middle prayer until the sun set.” And it is the *Asr* prayer.”

2. عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ ، قَالَ: كَانَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَدْعُو وَيَقُولُ: «اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي أَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ، وَمِنْ عَذَابِ النَّارِ، وَمِنْ فِتْنَةِ الْمَحْيَا وَالْمَمَاتِ، وَمِنْ فِتْنَةِ الْمَسِيحِ الدَّجَالِ»⁵³

Abu Hurairah narrated: “The Prophet ﷺ would supplicate and say: “O Allah, **I seek refuge in You from the punishment of the grave**, and from the punishment of Hell-fire, and from the trials of life and death, and from the evil of the trial of the False Messiah.”

3. وَ مِنْ حَدِيثِ أُمِّ سَلَمَةَ: قَالَ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ: «اللَّهُمَّ اغْفِرْ لِأَبِي سَلَمَةَ وَارْفَعْ دَرَجَتَهُ فِي الْمَهْدِيِّينَ، وَاخْلُفْهُ فِي عَقِبِهِ فِي الْغَابِرِينَ، وَاعْفِرْ لَنَا وَلَهُ يَا رَبَّ الْعَالَمِينَ، وَافْسَحْ لَهُ فِي قَبْرِهِ، وَنَوِّرْ لَهُ فِيهِ»⁵⁴

In a portion of a hadith narrated by Umm Salamah the Prophet ﷺ said: “Oh Allah forgive Abu Salamah and raise his ranks among the rightly guided, and grant him a succession in his descendants who remain, forgive both us and him, Lord of the universe, **make his grave spacious for him and grant him light in it.**”

4. عَنِ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ ، مَرَّ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ عَلَى قَبْرَيْنِ فَقَالَ: «إِنَّهُمَا لَيُعَذَّبَانِ وَمَا يُعَذَّبَانِ مِنْ كَبِيرٍ» ثُمَّ قَالَ: «بَلَى أَمَا أَحَدُهُمَا فَكَانَ يَسْعَى بِالنَّمِيمَةِ، وَأَمَّا أَحَدُهُمَا فَكَانَ لَا يَسْتَتِرُ مِنْ بَوْلِهِ» قَالَ: ثُمَّ أَخَذَ عُودًا رَطْبًا، فَكَسَرَهُ بِإِثْنَتَيْنِ، ثُمَّ غَرَزَ كُلَّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهُمَا عَلَى قَبْرٍ، ثُمَّ قَالَ: «لَعَلَّهُ يُخَفَّفُ عَنْهُمَا مَا لَمْ يَيَّسَا»⁵⁵

Ibn Abbas narrated that the Prophet ﷺ passed by two graves and said: “They are being punished and they are not being punished for a major

⁵² Bukhari, 6396 and Muslim, 627

⁵³ Bukhari, 1377 and Muslim, 588

⁵⁴ Muslim, 920

⁵⁵ Bukhari, 1378

thing (in their understanding). As for one of them, they used to slander others. As for the other, he would not protect himself from his urine.” Ibn Abbas said: “He then took a fresh branch and broke it into two pieces and placed one piece into each grave. He then said ﷺ: “Perhaps their punishment will be lightened until these two branches dry.”

5. عَنْ الْبَرَاءِ بْنِ عَازِبٍ ، عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «إِذَا أُفْعِدَ الْمُؤْمِنُ فِي قَبْرِهِ أُتِيَ، ثُمَّ شَهِدَ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، فَذَلِكَ قَوْلُهُ: ﴿يُثَبِّتُ اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا بِالْقَوْلِ الثَّابِتِ﴾ [إبراهيم ٢٧] حَدَّثَنَا مُحَمَّدُ بْنُ بَشَّارٍ، حَدَّثَنَا غُنْدَرٌ، حَدَّثَنَا شُعْبَةُ بِهَذَا - وَزَادَ - ﴿يُثَبِّتُ اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا﴾ [إبراهيم ٢٧] نَزَلَتْ فِي عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ⁵⁶

Al-Baraa ibn Azib narrated that the Prophet ﷺ said: “ When a believer is placed into their grave and the angels come to them and they testify that there is nothing worthy of worship but Allah and that Muhammad is the messenger of Allah, that is the meaning of the verse: “Allah keeps firm those who believe, with the firm word...”. In one narration it is added: “This verse was revealed regarding the punishment of the grave.”

6. عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «إِذَا فُيِّرَ أَحَدُكُمْ أَوْ الْإِنْسَانُ أَتَاهُ مَلَكَانِ أَسْوَدَانِ أَرْرَقَانِ يُقَالُ لِأَحَدِهِمَا: الْمُنْكَرُ وَالْآخَرُ: التَّكْوِينُ فَيَقُولَانِ لَهُ: مَا كُنْتَ تَقُولُ فِي هَذَا الرَّجُلِ مُحَمَّدٍ؟ فَهُوَ قَائِلٌ مَا كَانَ يَقُولُ.

فَإِنْ كَانَ مُؤْمِنًا قَالَ: هُوَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولُهُ أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدَ عَبْدُهُ وَرَسُولُهُ فَيَقُولَانِ لَهُ: إِنْ كُنَّا لِنَعْلَمُ إِنَّكَ لَتَقُولُ ذَلِكَ ثُمَّ يَفْسَخُ لَهُ فِي قَبْرِهِ سَبْعُونَ ذِرَاعًا فِي سَبْعِينَ ذِرَاعًا وَيُنَوَّرُ لَهُ فِيهِ فَيُقَالُ لَهُ: نَمْ فَيَنَامُ كَنَوْمَةِ الْعُرُوسِ الَّذِي لَا يُوقِظُهُ إِلَّا أَحَبُّ أَهْلِهِ إِلَيْهِ حَتَّى يَبْعَثَهُ اللَّهُ مِنْ مَضْجَعِهِ ذَلِكَ.

⁵⁶ Bukhari, 1369

وإن كَانَ مُنَافِقًا قَالَ: لَا أَذْرِي كُنْتُ أَسْمَعُ النَّاسَ يَقُولُونَ شَيْئًا فَكُنْتُ أَقُولُهُ فَيَقُولَانِ لَهُ:
 إِنَّ كُنَّا لَنَعْلَمُ أَنَّكَ تَقُولُ ذَلِكَ ثُمَّ يُقَالُ لِلْأَرْضِ: التَّيْمِي عَلَيْهِ فَتَلْتَمِمْ عَلَيْهِ حَتَّى تَخْتَلِفَ فِيهَا
 أَضْلَاعُهُ فَلَا يَزَالُ مُعَذَّبًا حَتَّى يَبْعَثَهُ اللَّهُ مِنْ مَضْجَعِهِ ذَلِكَ»⁵⁷

Abu Hurairah narrated that the Prophet ﷺ said: “When one of you (or when the human) is placed in their grave, they are approached by two dark angels with blue eyes, one of them is called Munkar and the other is called Nakeer. They will say to them: “What did you say regarding this man Muhammad?”. And they will say what they used to say.

If they were a believer they will say: “He is the servant of Allah and His messenger and I testify that there is none worthy of worship but Allah and that Muhammad is his servant and messenger.” They will then say: “We certainly knew that you used to say this.” Then their grave will be expanded 70 cubits by 70 cubits and it is illuminated for them. It will then be said to them: “Sleep like a newlywed, whom none awakens but the most beloved of their family.” Until Allah resurrects them from that resting place.

If they were a hypocrite they will say: “I don’t know, I heard the eople saying something so I said as they said.” The angles will then say: “We certainly knew that you used to say that.” It will then be said to the earth: “Constrict them”. So it constricts them, squeezing their ribs into each other. This punishment will continue until Allah resurrects them from that place.”

7. سَمِعْتُ أَبَا سَعِيدٍ الْخُدْرِيَّ، يَقُولُ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «يُسَلَّطُ عَلَى الْكَافِرِ فِي قَبْرِهِ تِسْعَةٌ
 وَتِسْعُونَ تَنِينًا تَنْهَشُهُ وَتَلْدَغُهُ، حَتَّى تَقُومَ السَّاعَةُ، فَلَوْ أَنَّ تَنِينًا مِنْهَا نَفَخَتْ فِي الْأَرْضِ مَا أُنبِتَتْ
 خَضِرًا»⁵⁸

Abu Sa’eed Al-Khudri narrated: The Prophet ﷺ said: “ 99 dragons will be unleashed upon the disbeliever in their grave, biting and stinging

⁵⁷ Ibn Hibban, 3117 and Tirmidhi, 1071

⁵⁸ Ibn Hibban, 3121

them until the day of judgment. If a single dragon from them were to breathe upon the earth it would not bring forth any vegetation.”

8. عَنْ عَائِشَةَ : أَنَّ يَهُودِيَّةً دَخَلَتْ عَلَيْهَا، فَذَكَرَتْ عَذَابَ الْقَبْرِ، فَقَالَتْ لَهَا: أَعَاذُكَ اللَّهُ مِنْ عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ، فَسَأَلَتْ عَائِشَةُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ عَنْ عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ، فَقَالَ: «نَعَمْ، عَذَابُ الْقَبْرِ» قَالَتْ عَائِشَةُ: فَمَا رَأَيْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ بَعْدُ صَلَّى صَلَاةً إِلَّا تَعَوَّذَ مِنْ عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ زَادَ عُذْرُ: «عَذَابُ الْقَبْرِ حَقٌّ»⁵⁹

Aisha narrated: A Jewish women entered upon her and mentioned the punishment of the grave and saying to her: “May Allah protect you from the punishment of the grave.” Aisha then asked the messenger of Allah ﷺ about the punishment of the grave. He said: “Yes, the punishment of the grave.” She said: I did not see the Prophet ﷺ pray a prayer after this except he sought refuge from the punishment of the grave. Some narrators added: “Yes, the punishment of the grave **is true**.”

9. عَنْ أَسْمَاءَ، قَالَتْ: أَتَيْتُ عَائِشَةَ وَهِيَ تُصَلِّي فَقُلْتُ: مَا شَأْنُ النَّاسِ؟ فَأَشَارَتْ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ، فَإِذَا النَّاسُ قِيَامٌ، فَقَالَتْ: سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ، قُلْتُ: آيَةٌ؟ فَأَشَارَتْ بِرَأْسِهَا: أَيْ نَعَمْ، فَقُمْتُ حَتَّى تَجَلَّانِي الْعَشِيُّ، فَجَعَلْتُ أَصْبُ عَلَى رَأْسِي الْمَاءَ، فَحَمِدَ اللَّهُ النَّبِيَّ ﷺ وَأَتْنَى عَلَيْهِ، ثُمَّ قَالَ: «مَا مِنْ شَيْءٍ لَمْ أَكُنْ أَرِيتهُ إِلَّا رَأَيْتُهُ فِي مَقَامِي، حَتَّى الْجَنَّةُ وَالنَّارُ، فَأَوْجِي إِلَيَّ: أَنْكُمْ تُفْتَنُونَ فِي قُبُورِكُمْ - مِثْلَ أَوْ - قَرِيبَ - لَا أَدْرِي أَيُّ ذَلِكَ قَالَتْ أَسْمَاءُ - مِنْ فِتْنَةِ الْمَسِيحِ الدَّجَالِ، يُقَالُ مَا عَلِمْتُكَ بِهَذَا الرَّجُلِ؟ فَأَمَّا الْمُؤْمِنُ أَوْ الْمُؤِقِنُ - لَا أَدْرِي بِأَيِّهِمَا قَالَتْ أَسْمَاءُ - فَيَقُولُ: هُوَ مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، جَاءَنَا بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ وَالْهُدَى، فَأَجَبْنَا وَاتَّبَعْنَا، هُوَ مُحَمَّدٌ ثَلَاثًا، فَيُقَالُ: نَمْ صَالِحًا قَدْ عَلِمْنَا إِنَّ كُنْتَ لَمُوقِنًا بِهِ. وَأَمَّا الْمُنَافِقُ أَوْ الْمُرتَابُ - لَا أَدْرِي أَيُّ ذَلِكَ قَالَتْ أَسْمَاءُ - فَيَقُولُ: لَا أَدْرِي، سَمِعْتُ النَّاسَ يَقُولُونَ شَيْئًا فَقُلْتُهُ»⁶⁰

Asma said: I came to Aisha while she was praying and I said: “What has happened to the people.” So she indicated to the sky. (I looked towards the mosque) and found that the people were standing in prayer. She then

⁵⁹ Bukhari, 1372

⁶⁰ Bukhari, 86

said: “Subhan Allah”. I said: “Is there a sign (Ayah).” She nodded her head in the affirmative. So I stood in prayer until I nearly fell unconscious. I then poured water on my head. (After the prayer) The Prophet ﷺ praised and glorified Allah and then said: “There is nothing that he hadn’t seen except he was shown it in that place, even heaven and hellfire. It was revealed to me that you are tested in your graves similar to the test of the test of the false messiah. It will be said: “What is your knowledge of this man?” As for the believer or the one with conviction in Allah, they will say: “This is Muhammad the messenger of Allah, he came to us with clear signs and guidance, so we accepted and followed, he is Muhammad.” Three times. It will be said to them: “Sleep in peace, we knew that you had conviction in him.” As for the hypocrite or the one in doubt, they will say: “I don’t know, I heard people say something so I said it.”

10. عَنْ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ كَانَ يُعَلِّمُهُمْ هَذَا الدُّعَاءَ كَمَا يُعَلِّمُهُمُ السُّورَةَ مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ يَقُولُ قَوْلًا: «اللَّهُمَّ إِنَّا نَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ عَذَابِ جَهَنَّمَ، وَأَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ، وَأَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ فِتْنَةِ الْمَسِيحِ الدَّجَالِ، وَأَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ فِتْنَةِ الْمَحْيَا وَالْمَمَاتِ»⁶¹

Ibn Abbas narrated: The Prophet ﷺ would teach them this supplication as he would teach them chapters of the Quran. He would say: “Oh Allah, I seek refuge in you from the punishment of the hellfire, and from the punishment of the grave, and from the tribulation of the false messiah, and from the tribulation of life and death.”

The great 4th century scholar of Hadith, *Al-Imam Al-Ajurri* stated in his masterpiece: *Al-Shari’ah* after narrating 18 narrations with his own chain regarding this matter:

مَا أَسْوَأَ حَالٍ مَنْ كَذَّبَ بِهَذِهِ الْأَحَادِيثِ، لَقَدْ ضَلَّ ضَلَالًا بَعِيدًا، وَخَسِرَ خُسْرَانًا مُبِينًا

“How wretched is the state of the one who denies these narrations, they have strayed far off the path, and lost a clear loss.”⁶²

⁶¹ Muslim, 590

⁶² Vol. 1, Pg. 774, Dar Al-Hadi Al-Nabawi, 2010

4.6 THE COMPANIONS AFFIRMING THE LIFE OF THE GRAVE

Among the main proofs of the collective and unanimous belief of the companions in the life of the grave, is the fact that they transmitted massive amounts of narrations in this regard. In this chapter I will suffice upon mentioning the names of the companions who narrated regarding this topic, in order to keep the discussion concise.

Among the companions who narrated about this topic are: Aisha, Ibn Abbas, Abu Hurairah, Zaid ibn Thabit, Anas ibn Malik, Abu Ayub Al-Ansari, Al-Baraa ibn 'Azib, Jabir ibn Abdullah, Umm Mubashir, Ibn Umar, Abu Umamah, Abdulrahman ibn Hasanah, Maymunah, Ibn Mas'oud, Abdulrahman ibn Samurah, Al-Miqdam ibn Ma'di Karib, Salman Al-Farisi, Fudalah ibn Ubaid, Huthaifah, Uthman ibn Affan, Abu Sa'eed Al Khudri, Tamim Ad-Dari, Basheer ibn Kamal, Thawban, Abdullah ibn Rawahah, Ubadah ibn As-Samit, Damurah ibn Habeeb, Umar, 'Amr ibn Al-'Aas, Abdullah ibn 'Amr ibn Al-'Aas, Mu'az ibn Jabal, Abu Al-Darda, Abu Talha, Abu Rafi', Abu Qatadah, Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari and Asma bint Abi Bakr. May Allah be pleased with them all.⁶³

These are 37 companions which have narrated various types of narrations affirming this belief. This undoubtedly shows this concept is established firmly and as Imam Taftazani said, has reached the level of *Tawatur*⁶⁴ in terms of its establishment.

4.7 STATEMENTS OF THE NOBLE SCHOLARS AFFIRMING THE LIFE OF THE GRAVE

As stated previously, there is a unanimous consensus of all scholars upon the Sunnah of the Prophet ﷺ and the belief passed down by the companions regarding the affirmation of the punishment of the grave. Here I will suffice upon mentioning a few statements from the most authoritative and widely accepted books of *Aqidah*, to serve as a testament that this belief is the mainstream belief and that various innovations regarding the life in the grave have never held weight in the mainstream scholarship.

⁶³ These are the companions whom Ibn Rajab mentioned in his treatise titled *Ahwal Al-Quboor wa AHwal Ahliha Ila Al-Nushoor*, Imam Suyuti mentioned in *SharH Al-Sudoor Bi-Sharh Hal Al-Mawta Wal Quboor*, along with some of the companions who's narrations were mentioned in *Mishkat Al-Masabeeh* of Tabrizi.

⁶⁴ It should be known that a condition of *Tawatur* is that a large group narrates the narrations in every level of the chain. This is the case with the narrations regarding the punishment of the grave however it would require a lengthy presentation which is not the purpose of this treatise.

1. قَالَ أَبُو حَنِيفَةَ مَنْ قَالَ لَا أَعْرِفُ عَذَابَ الْقَبْرِ فَهُوَ مِنَ الْجَهْمِيَةِ الْهَالِكَةِ لِأَنَّهُ أَنْكَرَ قَوْلَهُ تَعَالَى ﴿سُعَذَّبُهُمْ مَرَّتَيْنِ﴾ يَعْنِي عَذَابَ الْقَبْرِ. وَقَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى ﴿وَإِنَّ لِلَّذِينَ ظَلَمُوا عَذَابًا دُونَ ذَلِكَ﴾ يَعْنِي فِي الْقَبْرِ فَإِنْ قَالَ أُؤْمِنُ بِالْآيَةِ وَلَا أُؤْمِنُ بِتَأْوِيلِهَا وَتَفْسِيرِهَا قَالَ هُوَ كَافِرٌ لِأَنَّ مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ مَا هُوَ تَنْزِيلُهُ تَأْوِيلُهُ فَإِنْ جَحَدَ بِهَا فَقَدْ كَفَرَ⁶⁵
2. وَبِعَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ لِمَنْ كَانَ لَهُ أَهْلًا، وَسُؤَالِ مُنْكَرٍ وَنَكِيرٍ فِي قَبْرِهِ عَنْ رَبِّهِ وَدِينِهِ وَنَبِيِّهِ، عَلَى مَا جَاءَتْ بِهِ الْأَخْبَارُ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ - ﷺ -، وَعَنِ الصَّحَابَةِ رِضْوَانُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِمْ⁶⁶
3. وَعَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ لِلْكَافِرِينَ وَلِبَعْضِ عَصَاةِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ⁶⁷
4. كُلُّ مَا جُوزَ الْعَقْلُ وَوَرَدَ بِهِ الشَّرْعُ وَجِبَ الْقَضَاءُ بِثُبُوتِهِ فَمِمَّا وَرَدَ الشَّرْعُ بِهِ عَذَابُ الْقَبْرِ وَسُؤَالُ مُنْكَرٍ وَنَكِيرٍ وَرَدَ الرُّوحُ إِلَى الْمَيِّتِ فِي قَبْرِهِ⁶⁸
5. الْبَابُ الثَّانِي: فِي بَيَانِ إِنْ مَا جَاءَ بِهِ مِنَ الْحَشْرِ وَالنَّشْرِ وَالصِّرَاطِ وَالْمِيزَانِ وَعَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ حَقٌّ.⁶⁹
6. عَذَابُ الْقَبْرِ حَقٌّ لِقَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى ﴿التَّارِيعُضُونَ عَلَيْهَا غَدَا وَعَشِيَا﴾⁷⁰
7. وَعَذَابُ الْقَبْرِ وَنَعِيمُهُ حَقٌّ وَقَدْ اسْتَعَاذَ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ مِنْهُ، وَأَمَرَ بِهِ فِي كُلِّ صَلَاةٍ وَفِتْنَةِ الْقَبْرِ حَقٌّ، وَسُؤَالُ مُنْكَرٍ وَنَكِيرٍ حَقٌّ، وَالْبَعْثُ بَعْدَ الْمَوْتِ حَقٌّ⁷¹
8. وَالْقَالِثُ: مَسْأَلَةُ عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ، وَهِيَ أَسْهَلُ. وَلَا بُعْدَ وَلَا نَكِيرَ فِي كَوْنِ الْمَيِّتِ يُعَذَّبُ بِرَدِّ الرُّوحِ إِلَيْهِ عَارِيَةً⁷²
9. وَيَجِبُ الْإِيمَانُ بِكُلِّ مَا أَخْبَرَ بِهِ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ بَعْدَ الْمَوْتِ، فَيُؤْمِنُ بِفِتْنَةِ الْقَبْرِ، وَعَذَابِ الْآخِرَةِ وَنَعِيمِهَا، وَقَدْ اسْتَعَاذَ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ مِنْ عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ، وَأَمَرَ بِهِ فِي كُلِّ صَلَاةٍ⁷³
10. وَقَدْ اتَّفَقَ سَلَفُ الْأُمَّةِ قَبْلَ ظُهُورِ الْخِلَافِ وَأَكْثَرُهُمْ بَعْدَ ظُهُورِهِ عَلَى إِثْبَاتِ إِحْيَاءِ الْمَوْتَى فِي قُبُورِهِمْ وَمَسْأَلَةِ الْمَلَائِكَةِ لَهُمْ وَتَسْمِيَةِ أَحَدِهِمَا مُنْكَرًا وَالْآخَرَ نَكِيرًا وَعَلَى إِثْبَاتِ عَذَابِ الْقَبْرِ لِلْمُجْرِمِينَ وَالْكَافِرِينَ⁷⁴

⁶⁵ Al-Fiqh Al-Akbar, Abu Hanifa

⁶⁶ Al-Aqeedah Al-Tahawiya, Imam Tahawi

⁶⁷ Al-Aqaid Al-Nasafiya

⁶⁸ Luma' Al-Adillah, Abu Al-Ma'ali Al-Juwaini

⁶⁹ Al-Iqtasad fi Al-Itiqad, Al-Ghazali

⁷⁰ Usool Al-Din, Ghaznawi

⁷¹ Lum'atul Itiqad, Maqdisi

⁷² Al-Itisam, Shatibi

⁷³ Qatf Al-Thamar, Sideeq Hasan Khan

⁷⁴ Al-Ayat Al-Bayyinah, Ibn Al-Aloosi

11. ولا يجوز خلف منكر الشفاعة، والرؤية، وعذاب القبر، والكرام الكاتبين، لأنه كافر لتواتر هذه الأمور من الشارع⁷⁵

All of these are explicit statements from the great scholars of every generation affirming the belief in the life of the grave. I would like to highlight the statement of Imam Anwar Shah Kashmiri which shows the severity of this matter. He says while listing those deviant beliefs which make it impermissible to pray behind one who holds them:

It is not permissible behind one who denies intercession, or the believers seeing their lord in the afterlife, or the punishment of the grave or the angels who write deeds. For this person is a disbeliever, because these things have all been narrated through *Tawatur*.

5 CAN THE DEAD HEAR

After establishing the life of the grave as a fundamental belief of Islam, and that there is a connection between the body and the soul even after death, the extent of this connection is the next matter of discussion. One of the most common discussions regarding the dead is whether or not they can hear. This topic was discussed by the early scholars of Islam in detail.

In summary, there is consensus of the scholars that the dead can hear the living. They have differed on the exact capacity of this hearing, however to deny this concept entirely would demand the rejection of hundreds of narrations. One group of scholars has taken the rule to be that the dead cannot hear except the specific situations mentioned in narrations directly. Another group has taken the approach that the dead can hear generally, however the exact capacity of this hearing is unknown. In reality these views are very similar and differ on nuances, as both affirm that the Prophet ﷺ can hear and reply to those who send salutations upon him, as well as the salutation of the people of the graves upon entering the graveyard. In this chapter, I will first present the view of both parties along with their evidences from the Quran, Hadith, and various statements of scholars regarding this concept.

⁷⁵ Ikfar Al-Mulhideen, Kashmiri

5.1 EVIDENCE INDICATING THE DEAD CANNOT HEAR

5.1.1 Evidence from Quran

1. ﴿فَإِنَّكَ لَا تُسْمِعُ الْمَوْتَى وَلَا تُسْمِعُ الصُّمَّ الدُّعَاءَ إِذَا وَلَّوْا مُدْبِرِينَ ۖ وَمَا أَنْتَ بِهَادٍ الْعُمَىٰ عَنْ ضَلَالَتِهِمْ ۚ إِنَّ تُسْمِعُ إِلَّا مَنْ يُؤْمِنُ بِآيَاتِنَا فَهُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ﴾ [الروم: 52-53]

«So indeed, you will not make the dead hear, nor will you make the deaf hear the call when they turn their backs, retreating(52)

And you cannot guide the blind away from their error. You will only make hear those who believe in Our verses so they are Muslims [in submission to Allah](53)» [Ar-Rum: 52-53]

2. ﴿وَمَا يَسْتَوِي الْأَحْيَاءُ وَلَا الْأَمْوَاتُ ۚ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُسْمِعُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ ۚ وَمَا أَنْتَ بِمُسْمِعٍ مَنْ فِي الْقُبُورِ﴾ [فاطر: 22]

«And not equal are the living and the dead. Indeed, Allah causes to hear whom He wills, but you cannot make hear those in the graves(22)» [Fatir: 22]

3. ﴿إِنَّكَ لَا تُسْمِعُ الْمَوْتَى وَلَا تُسْمِعُ الصُّمَّ الدُّعَاءَ إِذَا وَلَّوْا مُدْبِرِينَ﴾ [النمل: 80]

«Indeed, you will not make the dead hear, nor will you make the deaf hear the call when they have turned their backs retreating(80)» [An-Naml: 80]

5.1.2 Evidence from Hadith

The main narration which this party uses is the narration in which Aisha denied the narration of Ibn Umar regarding the dead being able to hear.

عَنْ هِشَامٍ، عَنْ أَبِيهِ، قَالَ: ذُكِرَ عِنْدَ عَائِشَةَ، أَنَّ ابْنَ عُمَرَ يَرْفَعُ إِلَى النَّبِيِّ ﷺ «إِنَّ الْمَيِّتَ يُعَذَّبُ فِي قَبْرِهِ بِبُكَاءِ أَهْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ» فَقَالَتْ: وَهَلْ، إِنَّمَا قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «إِنَّهُ لَيُعَذَّبُ بِخَطِيئَتِهِ أَوْ بِذَنْبِهِ، وَإِنَّ أَهْلَهُ لَيَبْكُونَ عَلَيْهِ الْآنَ» وَذَلِكَ مِثْلُ قَوْلِهِ: إِنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَامَ عَلَى الْقَلْبِ يَوْمَ بَدْرٍ، وَفِيهِ قَتْلُ بَدْرٍ مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ، فَقَالَ لَهُمْ مَا قَالَ «إِنَّهُمْ لَيَسْمَعُونَ مَا أَقُولُ» وَقَدْ وَهَلَ، إِنَّمَا قَالَ: «إِنَّهُمْ لَيَعْلَمُونَ أَنَّ مَا كُنْتُ أَقُولُ لَهُمْ حَقٌّ» ثُمَّ قَرَأَتْ: ﴿إِنَّكَ لَا تُسْمِعُ الْمَوْتَى﴾ [النمل ٨٠] ﴿وَمَا أَنْتَ بِمُسْمِعٍ مَنْ فِي الْقُبُورِ﴾ [فاطر ٢٢] يَقُولُ: حِينَ تَبَوَّءُوا مَقَاعِدَهُمْ مِنَ النَّارِ.⁷⁶

It was mentioned to Aisha that Ibn Umar was attributing the following statement to the Prophet ﷺ: “The deceased is being punished due to

⁷⁶ Muslim, 932

their family crying over them”. She said: “He has erred, rather the Prophet ﷺ said: “They are being punished due to their sins while their family is crying over them.” And this is similar to his (Ibn Umar’s) statement that on the day of Badr the Prophet ﷺ stood over the well which had the bodies of the pagans and said: “They hear what I say.” And he has erred, in fact he said: “They know that what I used to say to them is true.” Then she recited the verses:

﴿إِنَّكَ لَا تَسْمِعُ الْمَوْتَى وَلَا تُسْمِعُ الصُّمَّ الدُّعَاءَ إِذَا وَلَّوْا مُدْبِرِينَ﴾ [النمل: 80]

«Indeed, you will not make the dead hear, nor will you make the deaf hear the call when they have turned their backs retreating(80)» [An-Naml: 80]

﴿وَمَا يَسْتَوِي الْأَحْيَاءُ وَلَا الْأَمْوَاتُ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُسْمِعُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَمَا أَنتَ بِمُسْمِعٍ مَنْ فِي الْقُبُورِ﴾ [فاطر: 22]

«And not equal are the living and the dead. Indeed, Allah causes to hear whom He wills, but you cannot make hear those in the graves(22)» [Fatir: 22]

He means when they have taken their places in hellfire (Ie. You cannot make them understand after they have taken their places in hellfire.)”

5.1.3 Statements of Scholars

There is a minority group of scholars who hold this view, among them are Abu Ya’la Al-Hanbali, Ibn Al-Aloosi, and others. They derived this opinion from the above verses and narrations as well as the statements of many jurists. Many jurists have indicated to support of this opinion under discussions of certain types of oaths. For example, if one were to take an oath that they will not speak to an individual, and they speak to them after they pass away, this person has not broken their oath. If the dead could hear then they would have definitely broken their oath.⁷⁷

Keep in mind that these scholars affirm that the dead can hear under certain circumstances that have been explicitly mentioned in narrations.

⁷⁷ For detailed mention of the statements of these scholars, refer to Al-Ayat Al-Bayyinah Fi Adm Sima’ Al-Amwat by Ibn Al-Aloosi

5.2 EVIDENCE INDICATING THE DEAD CAN HEAR

5.2.1 Evidence from the Quran

Scholars have used the same verses that indicate to the life of the grave to prove that the dead can hear. There are no verses which explicitly affirm that they can hear, however, the general verses affirming their life along with specific narrations affirming hearing are used to establish their proof. For this reason, mainly narrations will be used to prove the hearing of the dead in this chapter.

The response that this group of scholars gives to the evidence of the other group in the Quran is as follows:

The 3 verses which the opposing party uses as evidence are in fact not referring to the physically deceased and their ability to hear. Rather these verses are metaphorical, referring to the state of the disbelievers. In these verses the disbelievers are compared to deceased individuals in that what they hear does not benefit them, for those whose hearts have been sealed will not be guided by the *Da'wah* they hear from the Prophet ﷺ. Therefore these verses came as a comfort to the Prophet ﷺ. Providing the message that you should not feel guilty if you are rejected, for those who truly benefit from these reminders are those with open hearts. This understanding is extremely clear when the context of the verses along with statements of the scholars are taken into consideration.

As for the verse of Surah Ar-Rum, it comes on the last page of the Surah. In this Surah numerous miracles and signs of Allah's oneness are mentioned and the disbelievers are constantly called to ponder upon these signs. From the beginning to the end, miracles and blessings are listed, then the disbelievers are commanded to ponder upon these signs. With this in mind, it is clear that this verse coming at the end of the Surah is in fact indicating: If after mentioning these dozens of signs and miracles and constantly reminding the disbelievers to ponder deeply about the reality of the world they still reject what you are saying, do not feel responsible for this. For you cannot benefit those individuals whose hearts are closed off and unresponsive like those of the deceased. You can benefit those who come with open minds and hearts and genuinely seek the truth.

As for the verse of Surah Fatir, it becomes clear when the context is taken into consideration just as the previous verse.

﴿وَمَا يَسْتَوِي الْأَعْمَىٰ وَالْبَصِيرُ ۖ وَلَا الظُّلُمَاتُ وَلَا النُّورُ ۖ وَلَا الظِّلُّ وَلَا الْحَرُورُ ۖ وَمَا يَسْتَوِي الْأَحْيَاءُ وَلَا الْأَمْوَاتُ ۚ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُسْمِعُ مَن يَشَاءُ ۚ وَمَا أَنتَ بِمُسْمِعٍ مَّن فِي الْقُبُورِ ۚ إِنَّ أَنتَ إِلَّا نَذِيرٌ ۚ إِنَّا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ بِالْحَقِّ بَشِيرًا

وَنَذِيرًا وَإِنْ مِنْ أُمَّةٍ إِلَّا خَلَا فِيهَا نَذِيرٌ ﴿١٩﴾ وَإِنْ يُكَذِّبُوكَ فَقَدْ كَذَّبَ الَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِهِمْ جَاءَتْهُمْ رُسُلُهُمْ بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ
وَبِالْزُبُرِ وَإِلَّا كِتَابَ الْمُنِيرِ ﴿٢٠﴾ [فاطر: 19-25]

«Not equal are the blind and the seeing(19)

Nor are the darkness and the light(20)

Nor are the shade and the heat(21)

And not equal are the living and the dead. Indeed, Allah causes to hear whom He wills, but you cannot make hear those in the graves(22)

You, [O Muhammad], are not but a warner(23)

Indeed, We have sent you with the truth as a bringer of good tidings and a warner. And there was no nation but that there had passed within it a warner(24)

And if they deny you - then already have those before them denied.
Their messengers came to them with clear proofs and written ordinances
and with the enlightening Scripture(25)» [Fatir: 19-25]

In these verses multiple examples of given all describing the difference between believers and disbelievers. The passage then transitions to comforting the Prophet ﷺ. Allah mentions that other prophets were also sent with clear signs and their people still disbelieved. This understanding clarifies that the dead and living mentioned in these verses do not refer to physical dead and living.

As for the verse of Surah Naml, it also becomes clear when looking at the concept. This passage is also about those who deny the Prophet ﷺ as well as comforting him if they do not accept his message. Allah says earlier in this passage:

﴿وَلَا تَحْزَنْ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا تَكُنْ فِي ضَيْقٍ مِمَّا يَمْكُرُونَ﴾ [النمل: 70]

«And grieve not over them or be in distress from what they
conspire(70)» [An-Naml: 70]

This theme continuous in the next 10 verses and concludes by reminding the Prophet ﷺ that these individuals are similar to the dead, they are unresponsive to your words, they will not change and accept the message.

5.2.2 Evidence from Hadith

Imam Anwar Shah Kashmiri states in his commentary on Sahih Bukhari titled *Faid Al-Bari*:

والأحاديث في سماع الأموات قد بلغت مَبْلَغ التواتر.

The narrations regarding the hearing of the dead have reached the level of *Tawatur*.

This of course, like the life of the grave, refers to *Tawatur* of the concept. Meaning it was narrated from such a large number of companions and passed on in such a large number it would be impossible to have been fabricated. In summary, this concept has been narrated by the following 10 companions⁷⁸: Anas ibn Malik, Abu Ayub Al-Ansari, Abu Talha, Abu Hurairah, Umar, Ibn Umar, Ibn Abbas, Amr ibn Al-'Aas, Abdullah ibn 'Amr ibn Al-'Aas, Abu Sa'eed Al-Khudri, and Jabir. It should be noted that the narrations from these companions are varying in authenticity and content. Some narrations directly address the matter of the dead hearing the living, while others implicitly give this understanding. However, any reference to the dead being aware of the living supports this concept in general for hearing is a branch of awareness. I will suffice on 5 narrations in this section.

1. من حديث أنس، عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «الْعَبْدُ إِذَا وُضِعَ فِي قَبْرِهِ، وَتُوِّيَ وَذَهَبَ أَصْحَابُهُ حَتَّى إِنَّهُ لَيَسْمَعُ قَرْعَ نِعَالِهِمْ»...⁷⁹
2. عَنْ أَبِي طَلْحَةَ، أَنَّ نَبِيَّ اللَّهِ ﷺ أَمَرَ يَوْمَ بَدْرٍ بِأَرْبَعَةِ وَعِشْرِينَ رَجُلًا مِنْ صَنَادِيدِ قُرَيْشٍ، فَقَذَفُوا فِي طَوِيٍّ مِنْ أَطْوَاءِ بَدْرٍ حَبِيبًا مُحْبِثًا، وَكَانَ إِذَا ظَهَرَ عَلَى قَوْمٍ أَقَامَ بِالْعَرَصَةِ ثَلَاثَ لَيَالٍ، فَلَمَّا كَانَ يَبْدُرُ الْيَوْمَ الثَّالِثَ أَمَرَ بِرَاحِلَتِهِ فَشَدَّ عَلَيْهَا رَحْلَهَا، ثُمَّ مَشَى وَاتَّبَعَهُ أَصْحَابُهُ، وَقَالُوا: مَا نُرَى يَنْطَلِقُ إِلَّا لِبَعْضِ حَاجَتِهِ، حَتَّى قَامَ عَلَى شَفَةِ الرِّكِيِّ، فَجَعَلَ يُنَادِيهِمْ بِأَسْمَائِهِمْ وَأَسْمَاءِ آبَائِهِمْ: «يَا فُلَانُ بْنُ فُلَانٍ، وَيَا فُلَانُ بْنُ فُلَانٍ، أَيْسَرُكُمْ أَنْتُمْ أَطَعْتُمْ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ، فَإِنَّا قَدْ وَجَدْنَا مَا وَعَدْنَا رَبَّنَا حَقًّا، فَهَلْ وَجَدْتُمْ مَا وَعَدَ رَبُّكُمْ حَقًّا؟» قَالَ: فَقَالَ عُمَرُ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، مَا تُكَلِّمُ مِنْ أَجْسَادٍ لَا أَرْوَاحَ لَهَا؟ فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «وَالَّذِي نَفْسُ مُحَمَّدٍ بِيَدِهِ، مَا أَنْتُمْ بِأَسْمَعَ لِمَا أَقُولُ مِنْهُمْ»⁸⁰

⁷⁸ This number is based on a brief glance at the narrations which directly relate to this topic. A more detailed search including narrations with subtle indications would result in a much higher number.

⁷⁹ Bukhari, 1338

⁸⁰ Bukhari, 3976

3. عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ، قَالَ: «إِنَّ الْمَيِّتَ يَسْمَعُ حَسَّ التَّعَالِ إِذَا وَلَّوْا عَنْهُ النَّاسُ مُدْبِرِينَ، ثُمَّ يُجْلَسُ وَيُوضَعُ كَفَنُهُ فِي عُنُقِهِ، ثُمَّ يُسْأَلُ»⁸¹
4. عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «مَا مِنْ أَحَدٍ يُسَلَّمُ عَلَيَّ إِلَّا رَدَّ اللَّهُ عَلَيَّ رُوحِي حَتَّى أُرَدَّ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ»⁸²
5. عَنْ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ مَرْفُوعًا: «مَا مِنْ أَحَدٍ يَمُرُّ بِقَبْرِ أَخِيهِ الْمُسْلِمِ، كَانَ يَعْرِفُهُ فِي الدُّنْيَا، فَيُسَلَّمُ عَلَيْهِ، إِلَّا رَدَّ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ رُوحَهُ، حَتَّى يَرُدَّ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ»⁸³

This group of scholars has responded to the statement of Aisha by mentioning that she was not present when this incident took place, while the other narrators of the incident like Abu Talha and Ibn Umar, were present. For this reason their narration will be given preference and perhaps it was a simple misunderstanding between the two parties.

5.2.3 Statements of Scholars

Ibn Al-Qayyim has authored one of the most widely accepted works regarding this topic and many other matters of the afterlife titled Kitab Al-Ruh. In this masterpiece he firmly upholds and defends the opinion that the dead are aware of the living in various ways. He states:

قد شرع النبي ﷺ لأمته إذا سلموا على أهل القبور أن يسلموا عليهم سلام من يخاطبونه فيقول
السَّلام عليكم دار قوم مؤمنين وهذا خطاب لمن يسمع ويعقل ولولا ذلك لكان هذا الخطاب
بمنزلة خطاب المَعْدُوم والجَمَاد. والسَّلفُ مجمعون على هذا وقد تواترت الآثار عنهم بأن المَيِّتَ
يعرف زيارة الحَيِّ لَهُ ويستبشر به

The Prophet ﷺ has commanded that when his nation sends salutations to the dead, they are to use a wording that addresses the deceased. That is: “Peace upon you oh believers.”. This address is only for those who hear and understand, otherwise this would be addressing non-existent things, or inanimate objects. The pious predecessors unanimously agree

⁸¹ Baghawi, Sharh As-Sunnah, 1521

⁸² Abu Dawood, 2041

⁸³ Al-Istithkar, Ibn Abdul-Barr, Vol.1, Pg.185, DKI

upon this, and the narrations are *Mutawatir* from them that the deceased recognizes his living visitors and is pleased by their visiting.

Anwar Shah Kashmiri responds to the evidence of the opposing group based on the statements of various jurists. He states that in reality this discussion does not prove that the dead cannot hear. Rather oaths in Islamic jurisprudence are heavily affected by the commonly understood usage of a word. The commonly understood usage of the word “speaking”, is that the individual you are speaking to is alive. Therefore, this individual will not break their oath as this is not the normal usage of the word speaking.⁸⁴

In reality even the first group who claims that generally the dead cannot hear, excludes certain situations which have been explicitly mentioned in narrations. Such as the narration of the dead hearing the greeting of those who greet them upon entering the graveyard. Therefore, one could ask, why should the general rule be that the dead cannot hear and their hearing be in certain exceptions. For it is equally, if not more in line with the narrations that the general rule is they can hear, and admitting that all of the details of their hearing is unknown to us except in the places clearly mentioned in narrations.

6 TYPES OF PEOPLE IN THE GRAVE

As mentioned in previous chapters, the state in which an individual will be alive will be based on their status in this world

6.1 THE PROPHETS

It is from the beliefs of *Ablus Sunnah* that the Prophets are alive in their graves, and that their bodies do not decompose. This is stated explicitly in the following narrations:

1. عَنْ أَنَسِ بْنِ مَالِكٍ، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «أَتَيْتُ - وَفِي رِوَايَةٍ هَذَا: مَرَرْتُ - عَلَى مُوسَى لَيْلَةَ أُسْرِي بِي عِنْدَ الْكَثِيبِ الْأَحْمَرِ، وَهُوَ قَائِمٌ يُصَلِّي فِي قَبْرِهِ»⁸⁵

⁸⁴ Faid Al-Bari, Vol.3, Pg.42, DKI

⁸⁵ Muslim, 2375

Anas reported that the Prophet ﷺ said: “I passed by Musa on the night I was taken on the night journey, at the red sand dune while he was standing in prayer in his grave.”⁸⁶

2. عَنْ أُوَيْسِ بْنِ أُوَيْسٍ، قَالَ: قَالَ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ: «إِنَّ مِنْ أَفْضَلِ أَيَّامِكُمْ يَوْمَ الْجُمُعَةِ، فَأَكْثَرُوا عَلَيَّ مِنَ الصَّلَاةِ فِيهِ، فَإِنَّ صَلَاتَكُمْ مَعْرُوضَةٌ عَلَيَّ»، قَالَ: فَقَالُوا: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ: وَكَيْفَ تُعَرِّضُ صَلَاتُنَا عَلَيْكَ، وَقَدْ أَرَمْتَ؟ - قَالَ: يَقُولُونَ: بَلَيْتَ - قَالَ: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى حَرَّمَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ أَجْسَادَ الْأَنْبِيَاءِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِمْ»⁸⁷

Aws ibn Aws narrated that the Prophet ﷺ said: “Among the most virtuous days is the day of Friday. So increase in salutations upon me in that day, for your salutations are presented before me.” They said: “Oh messenger of Allah, how will our salutations be presented to you when you have perished.” He said: “Allah has forbidden upon the earth the bodies of the prophets.”

3. عَنْ أَنَسٍ أَنَّ النَّبِيَّ ﷺ قَالَ الْأَنْبِيَاءُ أَحْيَاءُ فِي قُبُورِهِمْ يَصَلُّونَ⁸⁸

Anas reported that the Prophet ﷺ said: “The prophets are alive in their graves praying.”

We can also derive the life of the prophets in the grave from the aforementioned verses regarding the life of the martyr. As the martyr is lower in status than a prophet, for the prophet is the reason the martyr fought in the path of Allah. Therefore the reward of the martyr belongs to the prophets as well. Finally, Imam Tajud-Deen As-Subki in his book *Shifa Al-Siqam* supports the view that this life of the prophets is both the life of the body and the soul, due to the evidences aforementioned.

6.1.1 The Prophet ﷺ is Shown the Actions of the Ummah

This is mentioned directly in a single verse in the Quran:

﴿وَقُلْ اْعْمَلُوا فَسَيَرَى اللَّهُ عَمَلَكُمْ وَرَسُولُهُ وَالْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَسَتُرَدُّونَ إِلَىٰ عَالِمِ الْغَيْبِ وَالشَّهَادَةِ فَيُنَبِّئُكُمْ بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ﴾ [التوبة: 105]

⁸⁶ The other interactions of past prophets can all be used as evidence in this chapter. For example: The meeting of the prophets during the night journey and praying in Jerusalem. As well as the discussion between Adam and Musa.

⁸⁷ Abu Dawood, 1531

⁸⁸ Bayhaqi, Hayatul Anbiya Fi Quboorihim.

«And say, "Do [as you will], for Allah will see your deeds, and [so, will] His Messenger and the believers. And you will be returned to the Knower of the unseen and the witnessed, and He will inform you of what you used to do."(105)» [At-Tauba: 105]⁸⁹

The Prophet ﷺ then describes how he will have this knowledge in a hadith narrated in Musnad Al-Bazzar:

عَنْ ابْنِ مَسْعُودٍ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - ﷺ -: «حَيَاتِي خَيْرٌ لَكُمْ تُحَدِّثُونَ وَيُحَدِّثُ لَكُمْ وَوَفَاتِي خَيْرٌ لَكُمْ تُعْرَضُ عَلَيَّ أَعْمَالُكُمْ فَمَا رَأَيْتُ مِنْ خَيْرٍ حَمَدْتُ اللَّهَ عَلَيْهِ وَمَا رَأَيْتُ مِنْ شَرٍّ اسْتَغْفَرْتُ اللَّهَ لَكُمْ»

Abdullah ibn Masood رضى الله عنه narrated that the Prophet ﷺ said: “My life is good for you, you come with new matters and new rulings are given for you. And my death is good for you, your deeds are presented before me, if I see good I praise Allah, and if I see bad I seek forgiveness for you.”⁹⁰

The Quran has also established that the Prophet ﷺ will be made a witness upon all of mankind on the day of judgment as mentioned in multiple verses. Among them are:

1. ﴿وَكَذَلِكَ جَعَلْنَاكُمْ أُمَّةً وَسَطًا لِتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ وَيَكُونَ الرَّسُولُ عَلَيْكُمْ شَهِيدًا﴾

«And thus we have made you a just community that you will be witnesses over the people and the Messenger will be a witness over you... (143)» [Al-Baqara: 143]

2. ﴿فَكَيْفَ إِذَا جِئْنَا مِنْ كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ بِشَهِيدٍ وَجِئْنَا بِكَ عَلَى هَؤُلَاءِ شَهِيدًا﴾ [النساء: 41]

«So how [will it be] when We bring from every nation a witness and we bring you, [O Muhammad] against these [people] as a witness?(41)» [An-Nisaa: 41]

⁸⁹ In this verse it is clearly mentioned that the messenger and the believers will see the actions of the other believers. One could say that this will be on the day of judgment however this is refuted by the end of the verse, the word *ثم* is used to denote an extended delay between two things. Indicating that they will see the deeds before the day of judgment. The verse also does not limit this showing of the deeds to any specific group of people, thus those who are present and absent are included in this.

⁹⁰ Musnad Al-Bazzar, 1925. This narration was deemed to be authentic by the great scholar of hadith, Imam Al-Iraqi in his book Tarh Al-Tathreeb. There are other narrations that support the meaning of this narration while some of them have weak chains.

3. ﴿وَيَوْمَ نَبْعَثُ مِنْ كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ شَهِيدًا ثُمَّ لَا يُؤْذَنُ لِلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا وَلَا هُمْ يُسْتَعْتَبُونَ﴾ [النحل: 84]

«And [mention] the Day when We will resurrect from every nation a witness. Then it will not be permitted to the disbelievers [to apologize or make excuses], nor will they be asked to appease [Allah](84)» [An-Nahl: 84]

4. ﴿وَيَوْمَ نَبْعَثُ فِي كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ شَهِيدًا عَلَيْهِمْ مِنْ أَنْفُسِهِمْ وَجِئْنَا بِكَ شَهِيدًا عَلَى هَؤُلَاءِ وَنَزَّلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ تِبْيَانًا لِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ وَهُدًى وَرَحْمَةً وَبُشْرَى لِلْمُسْلِمِينَ﴾ [النحل: 89]

«And [mention] the Day when We will resurrect among every nation a witness over them from themselves. And We will bring you, [O Muhammad], as a witness over your nation. And We have sent down to you the Book as clarification for all things and as guidance and mercy and good tidings for the Muslims(89)» [An-Nahl: 89]

5. ﴿وَجَاهِدُوا فِي اللَّهِ حَقَّ جِهَادِهِ هُوَ اجْتَبَاكُمْ وَمَا جَعَلَ عَلَيْكُمْ فِي الدِّينِ مِنْ حَرَجٍ مِلَّةَ أَبِيكُمْ إِبْرَاهِيمَ هُوَ سَمَّاكُمُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ مِنْ قَبْلُ وَفِي هَذَا لِيَكُونَ الرَّسُولُ شَهِيدًا عَلَيْكُمْ وَتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ فَأَقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآتُوا الزَّكَاةَ وَاعْتَصِمُوا بِاللَّهِ هُوَ مَوْلَاكُمْ فَنِعْمَ الْمَوْلَى وَنِعْمَ النَّصِيرُ﴾ [الحج: 78]

«And strive for Allah with the striving due to Him. He has chosen you and has not placed upon you in the religion any difficulty. [It is] the religion of your father, Abraham. Allah named you "Muslims" before [in former scriptures] and in this [revelation] that the Messenger may be a witness over you and you may be witnesses over the people. So establish prayer and give zakah and hold fast to Allah. He is your protector; and excellent is the protector, and excellent is the helper(78)» [Al-Hajj: 78]

6. ﴿وَنَزَعْنَا مِنْ كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ شَهِيدًا فَقُلْنَا هَاتُوا بُرْهَانَكُمْ فَعَلِمُوا أَنَّ الْحَقَّ لِلَّهِ وَضَلَّ عَنْهُمْ مَا كَانُوا يَفْتَرُونَ﴾ [القصص: 75]

«And We will extract from every nation a witness and say, "Produce your proof," and they will know that the truth belongs to Allah, and lost from them is that which they used to invent(75)» [Al-Qasas: 75]

Once it is established that the Prophet ﷺ will be a witness against all of mankind, it becomes clear that this would not be possible unless he had the knowledge regarding those he was testifying against. Therefore the meaning of the direct verses and narrations is established further.

6.1.2 Deceased Family Members are Shown the Deeds of the Living

The same verse of Surah Tawba previously mentioned includes the believers among those who will be shown the actions of others. There are narrations which expand on this meaning:

عَمَّنْ سَمِعَ أَنَسُ بْنُ مَالِكٍ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «إِنَّ أَعْمَالَكُمْ تُعْرَضُ عَلَى أَقَارِبِكُمْ وَعَشَائِرِكُمْ مِنَ الْأَمْوَاتِ، فَإِنْ كَانَ خَيْرًا اسْتَبَشَرُوا، وَإِنْ كَانَ غَيْرَ ذَلِكَ قَالُوا: اللَّهُمَّ لَا تُمِثَّهُمْ حَتَّى تَهْدِيَهُمْ كَمَا هَدَيْتَنَا».

It was narrated that Anas ibn Malik narrated from the Prophet ﷺ: “Your deeds are presented to your deceased relatives, if there is good they take glad tidings in it, and if there is other than good they say: “Oh Allah don’t let them pass away until you guide them as you have guided us.”⁹¹

6.1.3 Using the Prophet ﷺ as an Intermediary in Dua

This topic has been one of contention among early scholars as well as current scholars. Many books have been written on this topic and it has become a very controversial discussion, sometimes bringing on polemical or sectarian rifts. To avoid lengthening the discussion beyond the scope of this book, I will briefly mention the two main groups and some of their evidences.

Firstly, there are many ways that one can use an intermediary in dua. There are three ways which all scholars have agreed are permissible:

1. Using the names and attributes of Allah
2. Using a righteous deed that you have done
3. Using the dua of a righteous individual

In the first two methods, an individual is essentially asking Allah to accept their dua based on either one of Allahs attributes, or one of the individuals actions. For example: “Oh Allah you are the most merciful so have mercy on me.”. An example of the second method would be: “Oh Allah I have done such and such good deed, so

⁹¹ Musnad Ahmed (12683). There has been some discussion regarding the chain of this hadith and some other narrations that give the same meaning. However it is the opinion of many scholars, amongst them Sheikh Al-Albani that this narration is authentic. Furthermore, the wording of the verse in Surah Tawba gives a strong basis for this concept, which would bring more ease in accepting this narration as it is not establishing a new concept.

grant me such and such.”. In the third method the individual is in fact not making dua themselves at all. They are essentially using the piety and closeness of someone else to Allah, by asking that individual to make dua for them. Once again all 3 of these methods is unanimously agreed upon to be permissible.

The main method of dua in this manner which is disputed is using the Prophet ﷺ as an intermediary by saying: “Oh Allah by the honor of the Prophet ﷺ, accept this dua, or grant me such and such.”. Regarding this method scholars have divided into two groups.

The first group holds the opinion that using the Prophet ﷺ or anyone else for that matter as an intermediary in Dua is at the bare minimum not permissible at all and is not a legislated form of dua. Some who hold this opinion go even further and consider this type of dua to be *Shirk*, as they believe this directly contradicts the core principles of the oneness of Allah.

The second group holds this to be permissible and use narrations of these types of duas being allowed at the time of the Prophet ﷺ. There are long detailed discussions regarding the evidences of both groups and the details regarding each opinion, however for the scope of this book they will be omitted.

To provide a middle ground in this argument, one can bring the two opinions together as follows. When one is using the Prophet ﷺ as an intermediary or any other righteous person for that matter, one is in fact simply using the love they have for that person as their intermediary. As loving the Prophet ﷺ and the pious servants of Allah is undoubtedly among the best of deeds. So in reality this falls under the category of using righteous deeds as an intermediary. This of course is a concise mention of some aspects of this discussion and the full discussion is highly technical and is outside of the scope of this book.

6.2 THE MARTYRS

There is also unanimous consensus that the martyrs are alive in their graves as previously mentioned. It is well known that there are many different types of martyrs.⁹² For example: One killed in a battlefield, one who passes away while seeking

⁹² Imam Shihab Uddin As-Subki mentioned over 30 types of martyrs in his book *Fath Al-Ghafoor fi Sharh Mantboomatul Quboor*.

knowledge, one who passes away due to poison, one who passes away due to a stomach sickness, one who drowns to death, one who burns to death etc. All of these types are included in the life of the martyr mentioned in the Quran although the verse specifically mentions the first type. This is clearly mentioned by Imam Taqi Uddin As-Subki as well.

Another virtue of the martyrs is that they are among the 7 types of people who are exempt from being questioned in the grave. The other 6 individuals who will not be questioned are:

1. The one who guards the Muslim borders
2. The one who passes away in a plague
3. The *Siddeeq*⁹³
4. Children who pass away before puberty
5. One who passes away on Friday
6. One who recites Suratul Mulk before going to sleep

For a detailed discussion on these 7 types, refer to *Fath Al-Ghafoor fi Sharh Manthoomatul Quboor*, by Imam Shihab Uddin As-Subki.

6.3 THE PIOUS

Once a pious individual enters the life of the grave, they begin to experience some of the reward and blessings they earned in the worldly life. The Prophet ﷺ has informed us in detail of the process that takes place immediately after the death of an individual in this world. In an authentic narration mentioned in many books of hadith⁹⁴ it is mentioned:

ثُمَّ قَالَ: إِنَّ الْمُؤْمِنَ إِذَا كَانَ فِي قُبُلٍ مِنَ الْآخِرَةِ وَانْقَطَاعٍ مِنَ الدُّنْيَا، جَاءَهُ مَلَكٌ فَجَلَسَ عِنْدَ رَأْسِهِ، فَيَقُولُ: أَخْرَجِي أَتَيْتُهَا النَّفْسَ الطَّيِّبَةَ إِلَى مَغْفِرَةٍ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَرِضْوَانٍ، فَتَخْرُجُ نَفْسُهُ وَتَسِيلُ كَمَا يَسِيلُ قَطْرُ السَّقَاءِ - قَالَ عَمْرُو فِي حَدِيثِهِ، وَلَمْ يَقُلْهُ أَبُو عَوَانَةَ: وَإِنْ كُنْتُمْ تَرَوْنَ غَيْرَ ذَلِكَ - وَتَنْزِلُ مَلَائِكَةٌ مِنَ الْجَنَّةِ بِيضُ الْوُجُوهِ، كَأَنَّ وُجُوهُهُمْ الشَّمْسُ، مَعَهُمْ أَكْفَانٌ مِنَ أَكْفَانِ الْجَنَّةِ، وَحَنَوطٌ مِنْ حَنَوطِ الْجَنَّةِ، فَيَجْلِسُونَ مِنْهُ مَدَّ الْبَصَرِ، فَإِذَا قَبَضَهَا الْمَلَكُ لَمْ يَدْعُوهَا فِي يَدِهِ طَرْفَةَ عَيْنٍ، فَذَلِكَ قَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: {تَوَفَّتْهُ رُسُلُنَا وَهُمْ لَا يُفَرِّطُونَ} [الأنعام: ٦١].

⁹³ Scholars have differed over who this refer to, the opinion Imam Subki relies upon is that it is one who's actions confirm their belief consistently. While this may sound simple, this is in fact an extremely high rank that only the most righteous individuals have achieved.

⁹⁴ This narration is one part of the same narration used in the coming chapter regarding the wretched. This wording is narrated in Musnad Al-Tayalisi. Although a similar narration can be found in Abu Dawood, Nasai, and Ahmed.

قال: فتخرج نفسه كأطيب ريح وجدت، فتعرج به الملائكة فلا يأتون على جند فيما بين السماء والأرض إلا قالوا: ما هذا الروح؟! يقال: فلان - بأحسن أسمائه - حتى ينتهوا به إلى أبواب السماء الدنيا، فيفتح له، ويشيعه من كل سماء مقربوها حتى ينتهي به إلى السماء السابعة، يقال: اكتبوا كتابه في عليين: {وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا عَلِيُّونَ (١٩) كِتَابٌ مَرْقُومٌ (٢٠) يَشْهَدُهُ الْمُقَرَّبُونَ} [المطففين: ١٩ - ٢١]، فيكتب كتابه في عليين، ثم يقال: رُدُّوه إلى الأرض؛ فإني وعدتهم أنني منها خلقتهم، وفيها نعيدهم، ومنها أخرجهم تارة أخرى. قال: فيردُّ إلى الأرض، وتعاد روحه في جسده، فيأتيه ملكان شديدا الانتهاز، فينتهرانه ويجلسانه، فيقولان: مَنْ رَبُّكَ؟ وما دينك؟ فيقول: ربِّي الله، وديني الإسلام. فيقولان: ما تقول في هذا الرجل الذي بعث فيكم؟ فيقول: هو رسول الله صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ. فيقولان: وما يُدريك؟ فيقول: جاءنا بالبينات من ربِّنا، فآمنتُ به وصدَّقْتُهُ، وذلك قوله عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {يُثَبِّتُ اللهُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا بِالْقَوْلِ الثَّابِتِ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ} [إبراهيم: ٢٧]، ويُنادي مُنَادٍ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ: قد صدق عبدي، فألبسوه من الجنة، وأفرشوه من الجنة، وأروه منزله منها. فيلبس من الجنة، ويُفرش منها، ويرى منزله منها، ويُفسح له مدَّ بصره، ويمثل له عمله في صورة رجلٍ حسن الوجه، طيب الريح، حسن الثياب، فيقول: أبشِرْ بما أعدَّ اللهُ لك، أبشِرْ بَرْضوانٍ من الله وجناتٍ فيها نعيمٌ مُقيمٌ، فيقول: بَشْرَكَ اللهُ بخيرٍ، مَنْ أَنْتَ؟ فوجهُك الوجهُ الحسنُ الذي جاء بالخير، فيقول: هذا يومُك الذي كُنْتَ تُوعَدُ - أو الأمرُ الذي كُنْتَ تُوعَدُ - أنا عملُك الصَّالحُ، فوالله ما علمْتُك إلا كُنْتَ سريعا في طاعة الله، بطيئا عن معصيته، فجزاك اللهُ خيرا. فيقول: يا رَبِّ، أَقِمِ السَّاعَةَ؛ كي أرجعَ إلى أهلي ومالي.

Then he said ﷺ: “Once the believer is approaching the afterlife and has been severed from the worldly life an angel comes to him and sits near his head and says: “Exit oh pure soul forgiveness from Allah and His pleasure. The soul then pours out as water pours from a vessel, even if you may see other than that.”⁹⁵ Then angels will come from the heavens with bright faces, as if their faces are the sun. They come with shrouds from paradise and fragrance from paradise, and they sit around him as far as the eye can see. Once the angel removes the soul they take it within the blink of an eye, and this is the meaning of the verse: “Our messengers take the soul and they do not fall short.”

The soul exits like the purest of wind, and the angels raise it through the heavens, they do not pass by a group of angels except they ask: “What is this soul?”. Then it is said to them: “So and so” calling them with the best of names. Until they reach the doors

⁹⁵ This refers to the situation in which a pious individual may appear to be struggling at the time of death. This hadith teaches that if an individual is pious regardless of what their physical body may be showing, the soul will leave with great ease.

of the first heaven, they are opened for him, and the most pious angels from each sky join the procession and continue to the 7th heaven. It is then said: “Write his book in *Iliyeen*⁹⁶, and what informs you about *Iliyeen*, the finalized book, the most pious angels attend this moment.”⁹⁷ Their book is then placed in *Iliyeen*, then it is said: “Return him to the earth, for I have promised that from it I have created them, and to it I will return them, and from it I will bring them forth once again.” They are then returned to the earth, and the soul is returned to the body. Two intimidating angels will come forth, scold him, and seat him. They will then say: “Who is your lord, what is your religion.” He will respond: “My lord is Allah and my religion is Islam.” They will say: “What do you say about this man who was sent amongst you?” He will say: “He is the messenger of Allah ﷺ.” They will say: “What informs you of this?” He will say: “He came to us with the clear signs from our lord, I believed in him and trusted in him.” This is the meaning of the verse: “Allah makes the believers steadfast with the firm Word of faith in this worldly life and the Hereafter. And Allah leaves the wrongdoers to stray. For Allah does what He wills.”⁹⁸

An announcer from the sky will announce: “My servant has spoken the truth, cloth him from the clothes of paradise, give him bedding of paradise, and show him his abode in paradise.” They will then be given clothes and bedding from paradise and be shown his abode in paradise. His grave will then be expanded as far as the eye can see and his actions will be presented to him in the form of a man with a beautiful face, fragrance, and clothes. He will say: “Take glad tidings in that which Allah has prepared for you, take glad tidings in the pleasure of Allah and gardens in which there is eternal bliss.” He will reply: “May Allah give you glad tidings, who are you? For your face is the beautiful face which came with good” He will say: “This is the day that you have been promised, I am your righteous deeds, by Allah I did not know you except as one who was hasty in the obedience of Allah, hesitant in his disobedience, so Allah has rewarded you.” He will then say: “Oh my lord, bring the final hour upon us, so that I may return to my family and my wealth.”

⁹⁶ This is an Arabic word coming from a root which refers to, elevation and highness. There are 7 opinions from the scholars of Tafseer regarding this location. For a detailed discussion refer to Zad Al-Maseer of Ibn Al-Jawzi. In summary, this word refers to a very high place in paradise in which either the souls, the actions, or both are stored for the pious believers. This location was also referenced in chapter 3.2.

⁹⁷ These are verses 19-21 of Suratul Mutaifeen, which are being quoted by the angels at this moment.

⁹⁸ 14:27

6.4 THE WRETCHED

In the same narration previously mentioned the Prophet ﷺ informs us of what the wretched soul will experience upon leaving this world. He says:

قال: وإن كان فاجرًا، فكان في قُبُلٍ مِنَ الآخرة وانقطاعٍ مِنَ الدُّنيا، جاءه مَلَكٌ فجلسَ عند رأسه، فقال: اخْرُجِي أَيْتُهَا النَّفْسُ الْخَبِيثَةُ، أَبْشِرِي بِسَخِطِ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَغَضَبِهِ، فَتَنْزِلُ مَلَائِكَةٌ سُودُ الْوُجُوهِ، مَعَهُمْ مُسَوِّحٌ، إِذَا قَبَضَهَا الْمَلَكُ، قَامُوا فَلَمْ يَدَعَوْهَا فِي يَدِهِ طَرْفَةَ عَيْنٍ، فَتُفَرَّقُ فِي جَسَدِهِ، فَيَسْتَخْرِجُهَا، فَتُقَطَّعُ مَعَهَا الْعُرُوقُ وَالْعَصَبُ، كَالسُّقُودِ الْكَثِيرِ الشُّعْبِ فِي الصُّوفِ الْمَبْلُولِ، فَتُؤَخَذُ مِنَ الْمَلِكِ، فَيُخْرَجُ كَأَنَّ رِيحَ وَجِدَتْ، فَلَا تَمُرُّ عَلَى جُنْدٍ فِيمَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ إِلَّا قَالُوا: مَا هَذَا الرُّوحُ الْخَبِيثُ؟! فَيَقُولُونَ: فُلَانٌ -بِأَسْوَأِ أَسْمَائِهِ- حَتَّى يَنْتَهُونَ بِهِ إِلَى سَمَاءِ الدُّنْيَا، فَلَا تُفْتَحُ لَهُ، فَيَقُولُ: رُدُّوهُ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ؛ إِنِّي وَعَدْتُهُمْ أَنِّي مِنْهَا خَلَقْتُهُمْ، وَفِيهَا نُعِيدُهُمْ، وَمِنْهَا نُخْرِجُهُمْ تَارَةً أُخْرَى. قال: فَيُرْمَى بِهِ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ، وَتَلَا هَذِهِ الْآيَةَ: {وَمَنْ يُشْرِكْ بِاللَّهِ فَكَأَنَّمَا خَرَّ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ فَتَخْطَفُهُ الطَّيْرُ أَوْ تَهْوِي بِهِ الرِّيحُ فِي مَكَانٍ سَحِيقٍ} [الحج: ٣١]. قال: فَيُعَادُ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ وَتُعَادُ فِيهِ رُوحُهُ، وَيَأْتِيهِ مَلَكَانِ شَدِيدَا الْإِنْتِهَارِ، فَيَنْتَهَرَانِهِ وَيُجْلِسَانِهِ فَيَقُولَانِ: مَنْ رَبُّكَ؟ وَمَا دِينُكَ؟ فَيَقُولُ: لَا أَدْرِي. فَيَقُولَانِ: فَمَا تَقُولُ فِي هَذَا الرَّجُلِ الَّذِي بُعِثَ فِيكُمْ؟ فَلَا يَهْتَدِي لِأَسْمِهِ، فَيَقُولُ: لَا أَدْرِي، سَمِعْتُ النَّاسَ يَقُولُونَ ذَلِكَ، فَيَقُولُونَ: لَا دَرَيْتَ، فَيُضَيِّقُ عَلَيْهِ قَبْرُهُ حَتَّى تَحْتَلِفَ أَضْلَاعُهُ، وَيُمَثِّلَ لَهُ عَمَلُهُ فِي صُورَةِ رَجُلٍ قَبِيحِ الْوَجْهِ، مُنْتِنِ الرَّيْحِ، قَبِيحِ الثِّيَابِ، فَيَقُولُ: أَبْشِرْ بِعَذَابِ اللَّهِ وَسَخَطِهِ، فَيَقُولُ: مَنْ أَنْتَ؟ فَوَجْهُكَ الْوَجْهُ الَّذِي جَاءَ بِالشَّرِّ، فَيَقُولُ: أَنَا عَمَلُكَ الْخَبِيثُ، وَاللَّهِ مَا عَلِمْتُكَ إِلَّا كُنْتُ بَطِيئًا عَنْ طَاعَةِ اللَّهِ، سَرِيعًا إِلَى مَعْصِيَتِهِ.

قال عمرو في حديثه: عن المنهال، عن زاذان، عن البراء، عن التَّيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: فَيُقَيِّضُ لَهُ مَلَكٌ أَصَمُّ أَبْكَمٌ، مَعَهُ مِرْزَبَةٌ لَوْ ضُرِبَ بِهَا جَبَلٌ صَارَ تُرَابًا -أَوْ قَالَ: رَمِيمًا- فَيَضْرِبُهُ ضَرْبَةً يَسْمَعُهَا الْخَلَائِقُ إِلَّا الثَّقَلَيْنِ، ثُمَّ تَعَادُ فِيهِ الرُّوحُ، فَيَضْرِبُهُ ضَرْبَةً أُخْرَى.

“He then said: “And if he is a wretched individual and is approaching the afterlife and is being severed from the worldly life, an angel comes to him and sits near his head and says: “Exit oh filthy soul, take tidings of the anger of Allah and His punishment. Then dark angels come down with coarse, rugged clothes. Once the angel removes his soul the angels take it within the blink of an eye. The soul is scattered in the body and ripped out, ripping the veins and nerves, like a pitchfork ripping through wet cotton. It will be taken from the angel and the most vile stench will be excreting from it. It will not pass by a group of angels between the heavens and the earth except they will say: “What is this filthy soul?”. The angels will reply: “So and so”, calling him by his

worst names. Then they will reach the first sky, and it will not be opened for him, and it will be said: “Return him to the earth, I have promised them that from it I have created them, to it we will return them, and from it we will bring them forth once again.”. The soul will then be casted down from the sky, and the Prophet ﷺ recited the verse:

﴿وَمَنْ يُشْرِكْ بِاللَّهِ فَكَأَنَّمَا خَرَّ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ فَتَخْطَفُهُ الطَّيْرُ أَوْ تَهْوِي بِهِ الرِّيحُ فِي مَكَانٍ سَحِيقٍ﴾ [الحج: 31]

« And he who associates with Allah - it is as though he had fallen from the sky and was snatched by the birds or the wind carried him down into a remote place(31)» [Al-Hajj: 31]

The soul is then returned to the body, then two extremely intimidating angels approach him, scold him, and sit him down. They then ask: “Who is your lord, what is your religion?”. He will say: “I don’t know”. They will then say: “What do you say regarding this man who was sent to you?”. He will say: “I don’t know, I heard people saying such and such.”. They will say: “May you never know.”. The grave will then be tightened upon him until his ribs intertwine, and his actions are brought before him in the form of a hideous man, with a horrible smell, and disgusting clothes. He will say: “Take tidings in the anger of Allah and His punishment.” He will reply: “Who are you? For your face is the face of the one who comes with evil.” He will reply: “I am your evil deeds, by Allah I did not know you to be except very slow towards obeying Allah, very fast to disobey Him.”

In another narration: “A deaf and mute angel will be assigned to him. He will have a hammer that if it were to strike a mountain it would become rubble. He will strike him such a strike that every creature hears it except the humans and the jinn, then the soul is returned to the body and he strikes it once again.”

7 VISITING THE GRAVEYARD

There is unanimous consensus among the scholars of Islam that it is an encouraged act for men to visit the graveyard. A large group of scholars also holds that it is permissible or encouraged for women to visit the graveyards as well.⁹⁹

⁹⁹ It should be known that if there is fear that an individual will not be able to control themselves and may act in a manner that is unbefitting of the graveyard it is strongly disliked or could even be prohibited for them to visit the graveyards. This is due to the strict prohibition against wailing and other inappropriate actions that were common practice before Islam. Therefore extremely emotional individuals who may act uncontrollably or those who exaggerate emotions in order to comfort the family of the deceased are prohibited from visiting the graveyards.

It should be noted that this applies only to visiting the graves of Muslims. As for the graves of non-muslims the majority of scholars hold that they are not permissible to visit. While those who hold the position that it is permissible clearly state that one may not pray for them or ask for their forgiveness.

7.1 TRAVELLING TO VISIT GRAVES

The vast majority of scholars have permitted traveling for the sake of visiting graves as long as the rulings and etiquettes are maintained. A minority of scholars in the Shafi'i and Hanbali schools have maintained that it is not permissible to travel to visit graves due to the hadith of the Prophet ﷺ:

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «لَا تُشَدُّ الرَّحَالُ إِلَّا إِلَى ثَلَاثَةِ مَسَاجِدَ: الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ، وَمَسْجِدِ الرَّسُولِ ﷺ، وَمَسْجِدِ الْأَقْصَى»¹⁰⁰

Abu Hurairah reports that the Prophet ﷺ said:

There journey should be undertaken except to three mosques: “The sacred mosque (Mecca), the masjid of the Prophet ﷺ, and Masjid Al-Aqsa.”

While the majority responds that this refers specifically to mosques, as it is unanimously agreed that traveling for other religious activities is permissible, such as seeking knowledge. Therefore, this would not exclude visiting graves, specifically the graves of the Prophets, companions, and pious people.

7.2 VISITING THE GRAVE OF THE PROPHET ﷺ

There is unanimous consensus regarding the legislation of visiting the grave of the Prophet ﷺ. The scholars differed regarding the exact ruling, some have regarded it to be a preferable matter (*Mustahab*), while others have considered it to be an emphasized sunnah (*Sunnah Mu'akadah*), while some have even considered it to be compulsory (*Wajib*).

It should also be known that if there is any form of free mixing caused, specifically by younger women, attending the graveyards this would cause it to be strongly disliked. See Al-Fatawa Al-Hindiya and Al-Mawsoo'ah Al-Fiqhiya Al-Kuwaitiya for more detail.

¹⁰⁰ Bukhari, 1189

7.2.1 Etiquettes of Visiting the Grave of the Prophet ﷺ and Madinah

1. To intend the visitation the masjid of the Prophet ﷺ
2. To increase in sending blessings and salutations upon the Prophet ﷺ while approaching Madinah
3. To take a shower before entering the masjid
4. To wear the most elegant clothes available
5. To enter the city in a very humbler and composed manner
6. To ponder over the nobility of this city due to the nobility of its dweller ﷺ
7. To maintain all standard etiquettes of the masjid
8. To be very punctual in praying every prayer in congregation in the prophets mosque
9. To send salutations upon the Prophet ﷺ
10. To send salutations from others who requested you to convey their salutations
11. To send salutations upon Abu Bakr and Umar after visiting him ﷺ.
12. After sending salutations upon all 3, make any supplication that comes to heart, bearing in mind not to harm others in the crowd.
13. To pray in the *Rawda* (between the pulpit and the grave) and make Dua there as much as possible
14. To visit *Al-Baqee'* after visiting the Prophet ﷺ
15. To visit the graveyard of the martyrs at Uhud on Thursday
16. To visit masjid *Quba* on Saturday
17. Before departing from Madinah pray two *Rak'aat* in the masjid and visit the Prophet ﷺ once again.

7.2.2 Actions to Avoid While Visiting the Prophet ﷺ

1. To crowd and cause chaos around the grave of the Prophet ﷺ
2. To raise ones voice around the grave of the Prophet ﷺ, whether in salutations or supplication

3. To wipe or attach oneself to the wall of the grave of the Prophet ﷺ, rather the proper etiquette is to maintain a respectful distance as one would if they were visiting the Prophet ﷺ while he was alive in this world.¹⁰¹

7.3 ETIQUETTES OF VISITING THE GRAVEYARD

It is clear that visiting the graveyard is a great sunnah and well established practice in Islam that has many benefits. However, like any praiseworthy act, if it is not done according to the guidelines of Islam it can quickly become a blameworthy innovation. Therefore certain etiquettes must be upheld when visiting the graveyard to both maximize the reward of this act as well as avoid any innovations.

1. To have the specific intention of visiting the graves and attaining the virtue, not just walking through as a habit.
2. To be present minded and ponder over the reality of life and death while approaching the graveyard
3. To be in a calm, collected, and humble state
4. To recite the salutation upon entering the graveyard as mentioned in the hadith:

السَّلَامُ عَلَيْكُمْ أَهْلَ الدِّيَارِ مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَالْمُسْلِمِينَ، وَإِنَّا، إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ لِلْآحِقُونَ، أَسْأَلُ اللَّهَ لَنَا
وَلَكُمْ الْعَافِيَةَ.

“Peace upon you oh dwellers of these abodes from the believing Muslims, we are soon to be joining you, I ask Allah to grant us and you wellbeing.”¹⁰²

5. To avoid walking or sitting on top of graves
6. To approach the specific individual you are visiting as if you were visiting them in this world
 - a. The scholars have mentioned that it is permissible to both stand and sit while visiting a grave. Likewise to stand close or far, just as one would in the worldly life.
7. To refrain from wiping, kissing, or rubbing oneself with the dirt of the grave as this is from the customs of the Christians and is contrary to the composure of a believer.¹⁰³

¹⁰¹ Although this is a common practice amongst many, the scholars have clearly stated that this is against the etiquettes of visiting the Prophet ﷺ. For more detail regarding the etiquettes of Madinah see Al-Fatawa Al-Hindiya Al-Mawsoo'ah Al-Fiqhiya Al-Kuwaitiya, and Al-Fiqh Al-Islami Wa Adilatuhu.

¹⁰² Muslim, 975

¹⁰³ This is a common practice in many cultures while the scholars have clearly stated this as something to be avoided. It should be noted that certain scholars of the Shafi'i school and others permitted the touching of the graves as well as the

8. To make Dua for the deceased
9. To recite Quran with the intention of the deceased receiving the reward¹⁰⁴
10. To make Dua for oneself as well as the living Muslims
11. To avoid wailing and extreme reactions upon visiting the graves
12. To avoid rejoicing at the sight of a grave whom one disliked while they were alive
13. To avoid joking and laughing in the graveyard

7.3.1 Reciting Quran on Behalf of the Deceased

In modern times this has become a controversial practice which some cultures have adopted while others have not. This has led to tension regarding this act and whether it is permissible or not. In reality this is something that there was very little difference of opinion on in the early generations, and the relied upon position of the 4 major schools of thought is that this is an encouraged act. However, some individuals who have not extensively researched these discussions can be quick to dismiss this concept as something which was not known in the early generations of Islam. This is quite the contrary as this was a matter that was very well known during the time of the companions and those after them. I will suffice upon a few narrations as well as statements from reputable scholars regarding this matter.

Firstly it must be established that the concept of an individual benefiting from another's actions is entirely agreed upon in certain forms. Thus it is unanimously agreed that one can perform Hajj or Umrah on behalf of another individual, likewise give charity on behalf of another individual. It is also proven through countless proofs that people can benefit one another through dua. Hence for an individual to use the verses denoting that each person is responsible for their own actions as a rebuttal to this concept would not be valid.

Secondly it should be known that there are different types of deeds. Some deeds which are preformed through the body such as prayer, others preformed with money such as charity, and others which combine both, such as Hajj. Regarding these acts of worship Ibn Taymiyya has mentioned:

kissing of the graves of ones parents. For more information see Al-Fatawa Al-Hindiya and Al-Mawsoo'ah Al-Fiqhiya Al-Kuwaitiya

¹⁰⁴ This is a controversial practice in modern times while in reality there was little to no difference of opinion on the permissibility of this. All 4 schools of Islamic Jurisprudence hold that it is an encouraged action. For more detail see Al-Mawsoo'ah Al-Fiqhiya Al-Kuwaitiya.

وَأَمَّا «الْقِرَاءَةُ وَالصَّدَقَةُ» وَغَيْرُهُمَا مِنْ أَعْمَالِ الْبِرِّ فَلَا نِزَاعَ بَيْنَ عُلَمَاءِ السُّنَّةِ وَالْجَمَاعَةِ فِي وُصُولِ ثَوَابِ الْعِبَادَاتِ الْمَالِيَّةِ كَالصَّدَقَةِ وَالْعَتَقِ كَمَا يَصِلُ إِلَيْهِ أَيْضًا الدُّعَاءُ وَالِاسْتِغْفَارُ وَالصَّلَاةُ عَلَيْهِ صَلَاةُ الْجَنَازَةِ وَالِدُّعَاءُ عِنْدَ قَبْرِهِ. وَتَنَازَعُوا فِي وُصُولِ الْأَعْمَالِ الْبَدَنِيَّةِ: كَالصَّوْمِ وَالصَّلَاةِ وَالْقِرَاءَةِ. وَالصَّوَابُ أَنَّ الْجَمِيعَ يَصِلُ إِلَيْهِ

“As for recitation of Quran and charity and other types of good deeds, there is no difference of opinion amongst Ahlus Sunnah that one can gift the reward of acts of worship pertaining to wealth to others, such as charity or freeing a slave. Just as supplication, seeking forgiveness, and praying for one at the Janazah reach the deceased. The scholars have differed regarding the acts of worship pertaining to the physical body such as fasting, prayer, and recitation, and the correct position is that all of this reaches the deceased.”¹⁰⁵

This is also the position of the 4 major schools of thought as previously mentioned. More detail regarding the etiquettes of this will be mentioned in chapter 8.2.

8 HOW THE PIOUS PREDECESSORS VISITED GRAVES

Considering that visiting the graves is a matter legislated by Allah and the Prophet ﷺ, there are etiquettes and mannerisms attached to this act. Sadly there are many cultural practices that have become widespread and are now confused with religious practices. The best way to understand the Islamic etiquettes regarding the graveyard is to refer to how the pious predecessors would act in these places. This section will be specifically dedicated to quotes and narrations regarding this.

8.1 SILENCE AND CONTEMPLATION AT THE GRAVEYARD AND DURING THE JANAZAH

It was narrated regarding Abu Darda رضي الله عنه:

¹⁰⁵ Majmu' Al-Fatawa, Vol. 24, Pg. 366, King Fahad Print, 1995

كان أبو الدرداء يقعد إلى القبور فقليل له في ذلك فقال أجلس إلى قوم يذكرونني معادي وإن قمت عنهم لم يغتابوني

Abu Ad-Darda would sit near the graves and someone asked him about this. He said: “I sit with people who remind me of my afterlife and when I leave they don’t speak ill of me.”¹⁰⁶

It was narrated regarding Ibn Masood رضي الله عنه:

عن يزيد بن عبيد الله عن بعض أصحابه قال: رأى عبد الله بن مسعود رجلاً يضحك في جنازة فقال: أتضحك وأنت مع جنازة؟ والله لا أكلمك أبداً.

Abdullah Ibn Masood saw a man laughing during a janazah and he said: “Are you laughing during a Janazah? By Allah I will never speak to you again.”¹⁰⁷

Imam A’mash said:

أدركت الناس وإذا كانت فيهم جنازة جاؤوا فجلسوا صموتاً لا يتكلمون، فإذا وُضعت نظرت إلى كل رجل واضعاً حبوته على صدره، كأنه أبوه أو أخوه أو ابنه.

“I met the best of generations, if there was a Janazah amongst them they would sit silently and would not speak. Once it was buried I saw all of them with their head in their chest, as if it was their father or brother or son.”¹⁰⁸

Ayub Al-Sikhtiyani said:

كنت مع أبي قلابة في جنازة فسمعنا صوت قاص قد ارتفع صوت أصحابه، فقال أبو قلابة: إن كانوا ليعظمون الموت بالسكينة.

“I was with Abu Qilabah at a janazah and we heard a story teller who’s audience made a loud noise. Abu Qilabah said: “Those of the past would honor death by showing tranquility.””¹⁰⁹

Sallam ibn Abi Mu’Tee’ said:

¹⁰⁶ Ihya Uloom Ad-Deen, Vol.2, Pg.211, Dar Al-Marifah

¹⁰⁷ Shu’ab Al-Iman, Vol. 11, Pg. 459, Maktabatul Rushd, 2003

¹⁰⁸ Hayatus Salaf Bayn Al-Qawl wal Amal, Pg.707, Dar Ibn Al-Jawzi, 2012

¹⁰⁹ Ibid. Pg.707

وعن سلام بن أبي مطيع قال: شهدت قتادة في جنازة فلم يتكلم حتى انصرف، وشهدت الحريري في جنازة فلم يزل يبكي حتى تفرق القوم، وشهدت محمد بن واسع في جنازة فلم يزل مقنّع الرأس، مطرقاً، ما يلتفت يمينا ولا شمالاً.

“I saw Qatadah at a janazah and he didn’t speak until he left. I saw Al-Hariri at a janazah and he didn’t stop crying until everyone left. I saw Muhammad ibn Wasī’ in a janazah and he didn’t not lift his head nor turn left or right.”¹¹⁰

Sufyan ibn ‘Uyayna was asked:

لأي شيء كان يُستحب خفض الصوت عند الجنائز؟ قال: شبهوه بالحشر إلى الله، أما سمعته يقول: ﴿وَخَشَعَتِ الْأَصْوَاتُ لِلرَّحْمَنِ فَلَا تَسْمَعُ إِلَّا هَمْسًا﴾ [طه ١٠٨].

“Why is it preferable to lower ones voice at a janazah?” He said: “They would compare it to resurrection in front of Allah, have you not heard the verse: “And the voices are hushed in awe of the most-merciful, so you do not hear but whispering.”¹¹¹

Thabit Al-Bunani said:

إن كنا لنتبع الجنازة فما نرى إلا متقنعًا باكيًا، أو متقنعًا منكراً، قال ثابت: وإنك لترى الجنازة اليوم على عواتقهم، وأحدهم وإنه ليضحك.

“We used to attend a janazah and we would only see people covering their faces and crying, or covering their faces and in shock.” He then said: “Today you see people carrying a janazah on their shoulders and they are laughing.”¹¹²

Imam A’mash said:

إن كنا لنشهد الجنازة، فلا ندري من نعزي من حزن القوم.

“We used to attend a janazah, and we would not know who to console because of how sad everyone was.”¹¹³

¹¹⁰ Ibid. Pg.707

¹¹¹ Ibid. Pg.708

¹¹² Ibid. Pg.707

¹¹³ Ibid. Pg. 707

Imam Nawawi mentioned regarding the etiquettes of the one carrying the Janazah:

يُستحبّ له أن يكون مشغلاً بذكر الله تعالى، والفكر فيما يلقاه الميت، وما يكون مصيره، وحاصل ما كان فيه، وأن هذا آخر الدنيا ومصير أهلها، وليحذر كلّ الحذر من الحديث بما لا فائدة فيه، فإن هذا وقتُ فكر وذكر تقبُّح فيه الغفلة واللّهو والاشتغال بالحديث الفارغ، فإن الكلام بما لا فائدة فيه منهجيّ عنه في جميع الأحوال، فكيف هذا الحال.

واعلم أن الصواب المختار ما كان عليه السلف: السكوت في حال السير مع الجنازة، فلا يُرفع صوتاً بقراءة، ولا ذكر، ولا غير ذلك، والحكمة فيه ظاهرة، وهي أنه أسكنُ لخاطرهم، وأجمعُ لفكرهم فيما يتعلق بالجنازة، وهو المطلوب في هذا الحال، فهذا هو الحقّ، ولا تغترّ بكثرة من يُخالفه، فقد قال أبو عليّ الفضيل بن عياض ما معناه: الزم طرق الهدى، ولا يضرك قلة السالكين، وإياك وطرق الضلالة، ولا تغترّ بكثرة الهالكين.

“It is preferred to be occupied in the remembrance of Allah, and contemplation of what the deceased is experiencing and what they will experience in the near future. This is the end of the worldly life and the final destination for the people of the world. Hence, be extremely cautious of speech that has no benefit (during these events), as this is a time of contemplation and remembrance of Allah. Thus heedlessness, and pointless discussion become even more distasteful. For aimless speech is prohibited in general times, so how about in this situation.

Know that the correction position and that which the pious predecessors were upon was silence during the funeral procession. Therefore no one should raise their voice in recitation, nor remembrance, nor anything else. The wisdom in this is clear, as it is more peaceful for the mind and allows one to gather their thoughts and contemplate over the funeral, which is what is required. This is the truth, and do not be deceived by the large number of those who act otherwise. As Fudail ibn ‘Iyad has said: “Stay upon the paths of guidance and don’t be concerned by the quantity of travelers. And be cautious of the paths of misguidance, and don’t be deceived by the large number of the misfortunate.”¹¹⁴

It was also narrated that the pious predecessors would be engaged in remembrance of Allah while carrying the casket to the graveyard. It was narrated from Bakr ibn Abdullah Al-Muzani:

¹¹⁴ Al-Athkar, Pg 160, Dar Al-Fikr, 1994

«إِذَا حَمَلْتَ الْجَنَازَةَ فَسَبِّحْ مَا دُمْتَ تَحْمِلُهَا»

“When you’re carrying a casket, remain in remembrance for as long as you carry it.”¹¹⁵

8.2 AFTER THE BURIAL IS COMPLETE

Imam Nawawi has written a chapter in his momentous work Al-Athkar, regarding what should be done immediately after a burial. He mentions in it:

السنة لمن كان على القبر أن يحثي في القبر ثلاث حثيات بيديه جميعاً من قبل رأسه.

The sunnah for an individual attending a burial is to throw three handfuls of dirt upon the casket near the head.

قال جماعة من أصحابنا: يُستحب أن يقول في الحثية الأولى: (مِنْهَا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ) وفي الثانية: (وَفِيهَا نُعِيدُكُمْ) وفي الثالثة: (وَمِنْهَا نُخْرِجُكُمْ تَارَةً أُخْرَى) [طه ٥٦]

A group of scholars has said: It is preferred to say in the first handful “From it we created you” and in the second: “To it we will return you” and in the third: “And from it we will bring you forth once again.” {20:56}

ويُستحب أن يقعد عنده بعد الفراغ ساعة قدر ما يُنحر جزور ويُقسم لحمها، ويشغل القاعدون بتلاوة القرآن، والدعاء للميت، والوعظ، وحكايات أهل الخير، وأخبار الصالحين.

It is preferred to sit near the grave after the burial is complete for as long as it would take for a camel to be slaughtered and the meat distributed.¹¹⁶

روينا في «صحيح البخاري ومسلم» عن عليٍّ، قال: «كُنَّا فِي جَنَازَةٍ فِي بَقِيعِ الْغَرْقَدِ، فَأَتَانَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ، فَقَعَدَ وَقَعَدْنَا حَوْلَهُ وَمَعَهُ مَخْضَرَةٌ فَنَكَسَ، وَجَعَلَ يَنْكُثُ بِمَخْضَرَتِهِ...

¹¹⁵ Mussanaf Ibn Abi Shaybah, Vol.2, Pg.485, Maktabatul Rushd

¹¹⁶ This is derived from the coming hadith, in modern times, an expert can slaughter a camel and have the meat distributed in under 25 minutes.

It is narrated in Bukhari and Muslim from Ali عليه السلام: “We were in a funeral in Baqee’, and the Prophet ﷺ came to us and sat, so we sat around him and he had a staff with him, he lowered his head and began tapping the ground with his staff...”¹¹⁷

ورويانا في «صحيح مسلم» عن عمرو بن العاص قال: إذا دفنتموني أقيموا حول قبري قدر ما يُنحر جزور، ويقسم لحمها حتى أستأنس بكم، وأنظرَ ماذا أراجعُ به رسلَ ربي.

Imam Muslim narrated from ‘Amr ibn Al-‘Aas: “If you bury me then stay around my grave as long as it would take for a camel to be slaughtered and the meat distributed, so that I could take comfort from you, and see what the messengers of my lord will come with.”¹¹⁸

ورويانا في «سنن أبي داود» والبيهقي بإسناد حسن، عن عثمان، قال: كان النبي ﷺ إذا فرغ من دفن الميت، وقف عليه فقال: «اسْتَغْفِرُوا لِأَخِيكُمْ، وَسَلُّوا اللَّهَ لَهُ التَّثْبِيتَ فَإِنَّهُ الْآنَ يُسْأَلُ.»

Imam Abu Dawood and Imam Bayhaqi narrate with sound chain from Uthman:

“When the Prophet ﷺ would finish a burial he would stand at the grave and say:

“Seek forgiveness for your brother and ask Allah to keep him firm, for he is now being questioned.”

قال الشافعي والأصحاب: يُستحبُّ أن يقرؤوا عنده شيئاً من القرآن، قالوا: فإن ختموا القرآن كله كان حسناً

Imam Shafi’i and his followers say it is preferable to recite Quran at the grave, and if they were to recite the entire Quran that would be good.

ورويانا في «سنن البيهقي» بإسناد حسن، أن ابن عمر استحبَّ أن يقرأ على القبر بعد الدفن أول سورة البقرة وخاتمتها.

It is narrated by Imam Bayhaqi with a sound chain of narration that Ibn Umar عليه السلام liked that the beginning and end of surah Al-Baqarah were recited upon the grave after the burial.¹¹⁹

¹¹⁷ Bukhari (1326,4948) Muslim (2647)

¹¹⁸ Muslim (121)

¹¹⁹ Al-Athkar, Pg.161-162, Dar Al-Fikr, 1994

It was narrated regarding Abdullah ibn Abbas رضي الله عنه :

عَنِ ابْنِ أَبِي مُلَيْكَةَ، قَالَ: «لَمَّا فَرَّغَ مِنْ قَبْرِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ السَّائِبِ قَامَ ابْنُ عَبَّاسٍ عَلَى الْقَبْرِ فَوَقَّفَ عَلَيْهِ، ثُمَّ دَعَا، ثُمَّ أَنْصَرَفَ»

When Abdullah ibn Abbas concluded the burial of Abdullah ibn Al-Saib, he stood up, stood near the grave, made dua for him then left.¹²⁰

It was narrated regarding Ahnaf ibn Qays:

عَنْ خَالِدِ بْنِ سُمْيَرَ، قَالَ: كُنْتُ مَعَ الْأَحْنَفِ فِي جِنَازَةِ فَجَلَسَ الْأَحْنَفُ، وَجَلَسْتُ مَعَهُ فَلَمَّا فُرِغَ مِنْ دَفْنِهَا، وَهُوَ ضِرَارُ بْنُ الْقَعْقَاعِ التَّيْمِيُّ رَأَيْتُ الْأَحْنَفَ انْتَهَى إِلَى قَبْرِهِ، فَقَامَ عَلَيْهِ فَبَدَأَ بِالتَّنَاءِ عَلَيْهِ قَبْلَ الدُّعَاءِ فَقَالَ: «كُنْتُ وَاللَّهِ مَا عَلِمْتُ كَذَا ثُمَّ دَعَا لَهُ»

Khalid ibn Sumayr said: “I was with Ahnaf in a janazah, he sat and I sat with him. When the burial was complete, and the deceased was Dirar ibn Al-Qa’Qa’ Al-Tamimi, I saw Ahnaf go to the grave and stand near to it and begin praising the deceased before he started his supplication. He would say: “To my knowledge you were such and such.” Then he prayed for him.¹²¹

عَنِ الْبَرَاءِ بْنِ عَازِبٍ قَالَ: «خَرَجْنَا مَعَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ فِي جِنَازَةٍ، فَوَجَدْنَا الْقَبْرَ، وَلَمَّا يُلْحَدُ فَجَلَسَ، وَجَلَسْنَا»

Bara’a ibn ‘Azib said: “ We attended a funeral with the Prophet ﷺ, we reached the grave and it had not been dug entirely, so he sat and we sat.”¹²²

8.3 CRYING OVER THE DEAD

Anas bin Malik narrated:

¹²⁰ Musannaf Ibn Abi Shaybah, Vol.3, Pg.20, Maktabatul Rushd

¹²¹ Ibid. This narration shows the permissibility of sitting in the graveyard and that it was a common practice. It also shows the permissibility of praising the deceased, and mentioning their good qualities, as is proven through many authentic narrations.

¹²² Musnad Ahmed (18625)

شهدنا بنت رسول الله ﷺ ورسول الله ﷺ جالس على القبر. فرأيت عينيه تدمعان...

“We attended the burial of the daughter of the Prophet ﷺ and the Prophet ﷺ was sitting near the grave, then I saw his eyes tearing.”¹²³

Anas bin Malik narrated:

قال: دخلنا مع رسول الله ﷺ على أبي سيف القين وكان ظئرا لإبراهيم عليه السلام فأخذ رسول الله ﷺ إبراهيم فقبله وشمه. ثم دخلنا عليه بعد ذلك وإبراهيم يجود بنفسه فجعلت عينا رسول الله ﷺ تذرفان. فقال له عبد الرحمن بن عوف - -: وأنت يا رسول الله؟ فقال: «يا ابن عوف إنها رحمة». ثم أتبعها بأخرى فقال ﷺ «إن العين تدمع، والقلب يحزن، ولا نقول إلا ما يرضي ربنا، وإنا بفراقك يا إبراهيم لمحزونون»

“We entered upon Abu Saif with the Prophet ﷺ, and he was a caretaker of Ibrahim the son of Muhammad ﷺ. The Prophet ﷺ took Ibrahim and was kissing him and smelling him. Then we entered upon him after that when Ibrahim was passing away and the eyes of the Prophet ﷺ were flowing with tears. Abdulrahman ibn ‘Awf said to him: “ Even you oh messenger of Allah.” He said ﷺ: “Oh ibn ‘Awf, they are mercy.” Then he said ﷺ: “The eye may tear, the heart may grief, yet we don’t say except that which pleases our lord. And we are grieved oh Ibrahim by your departure.”¹²⁴

Abu Hurairah narrated:

زار النبي ﷺ قبر أمه فبكى وأبكى من حوله فقال: «استأذنت ربي في أن أستغفر لها فلم يؤذن لي. واستأذنته في أن أزور قبرها فأذن لي. فزوروا القبور فإنها تذكّر الموت»

“The Prophet ﷺ visited the grave of his mother and he cried and caused those around him to cry. He said ﷺ: “I asked my lord to allow me to seek forgiveness for

¹²³ Bukhari (1342)

¹²⁴ Bukhari (1303)

my mother and I wasn't given permission. And I asked him to allow me to visit her grave and he permitted me. So visit the graves for they remind of death.”¹²⁵

It was narrated regarding Umar رضي الله عنه:

وكان عمر إذا وقف على قبر بكى حتى تبتل لحيته ويقول سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يقول إن القبر أول منازل الآخرة فإن نجا منه صاحبه فما بعده أيسر وإن لم ينج منه فما بعده أشد

“When Umar would pass by a grave he would cry until his beard would become soaked and he would say: “I heard the Prophet ﷺ say: “ The grave is the first stage of the stages of the afterlife, if the individual is saved from it, then what is after it is easier. And if they are not saved from it, what comes after it is more difficult.”¹²⁶

It was narrated regarding the death of Umar رضي الله عنه:

بكى سعيد بن زيد فقال له قائل: يا أبا الأعور ما يبكيك؟ فقال: على الإسلام أبكي، إن موت عمر ثَلَمَ الإسلام، ثُلْمَةٌ لا تُرتق إلى يوم القيامة.

Sa'eed ibn Zaid cried and someone said to him: “Oh Abu Al-A'war, what makes you cry?” He said: “I cry over Islam, for the death of Umar has left a crack in Islam that will not be sealed until the day of judgment.”¹²⁷

وعن أبي وائل قال: قدم علينا عبد الله بن مسعود فنّعى إلينا عمر، فلم أَرِ يوماً كان أكثر باكياً ولا حزيناً منه، ثم قال: والله لو أعلم عمر كان يحب كلباً لإحبيته، والله إني أحسب العضاه قد وجدَ فَقَدَ عمر.

Abu Wai'l said: “Ibn Masood came to us and informed us of the death of Umar, I have never seen an individual cry or grief more than him on that day.” Then Ibn Masood said: “By Allah if I knew that Umar loved a dog I would have loved it. By Allah I feel that even the thornbushes are feeling the absence of Umar.”¹²⁸

¹²⁵ Muslim (976)

¹²⁶ Ihya Uloom Ad-Deen, Vol. 2, Pg. 210, Dar Al-Marifah

¹²⁷ Tabaqat Ibn Sa'd, Vol. 3, Pg. 372, Dar Sader, 1968

¹²⁸ Ibid.

8.4 BEING VISIBLY AFFECTED AFTER A JANAZAH

Ibrahim An-Nakha'i said:

كانت تكون فيهم الجنازة فيظلون الأيام محزونين يعرف ذلك فيهم. قال: وإنكم في جنائكم تتحدثون بأحاديث دنياكم.

“There would be a janazah amongst these people and they would remain in grief for days, it would be noticeable in them. While you are in your janazah’s speaking of matters of the worldly life.”¹²⁹

Salih Al-Murri said:

أدركت بالبصرة شبابًا وشيوخًا يشهدون الجناز، يرجعون منها كأنهم نشروا من قبورهم، فيُعرف فيهم والله الزيادة بعد ذلك.

“I met in Basra young men and elders that would attend a janazah. They would return from it as if they had been resurrected from their graves. By Allah there would be a noticeable change in their lives afterwards.”¹³⁰

It was narrated about Rabee’ ibn Abi Rashid:

وكان ربيع بن أبي راشد إذا مات أحد من جيرانه أنكره أهله أيامًا.

If one of his neighbors passed away, he was like a stranger to his own family for multiple days.”¹³¹

Hatim Al-ASam said:

مَنْ مَرَّ بِالْمَقَابِرِ فَلَمْ يَتَفَكَّرْ لِنَفْسِهِ وَلَمْ يَدْعُ لَهُمْ فَقَدْ خَانَ نَفْسَهُ وَخَانَهُمْ

“Whoever passes by the graveyard and doesn’t reflect nor make dua for them, they have betrayed themselves and the deceased.”¹³²

¹²⁹ Hayatus Salaf Bayn Al-Qawl wal Amal, Pg. 706, Dar Ibn Al-Jawzi, 2012

¹³⁰ Ibid. Pg. 707

¹³¹ Ibid. Pg. 708

¹³² Ihyā Uloom Ad-Deen, Vol. 2, Pg. 211, Dar Al-Marifah

8.5 NOT EATING AFTER A JANAZAH¹³³

It was narrated about Yahya ibn Abi Kathir:

وكان يحيى بن أبي كثير إذا حضر جنازة لم يتعش تلك الليلة، ولم يقدر أحد من أهله أن يكلمه من شدة حزنه.

When he would attend a janazah he would not eat that night, nor could any of his family members speak to him due to the severity of his grief.¹³⁴

It was narrated about Muhammad ibn Wasi' that:

أنه حضر جنازة، فلما رجع إلى أهله أتى بغدائه فبكى، وقال: هذا يوم منعَّص علينا نهاره، وأبى أن يطعم.

He attended a janazah, and when he returned to his family they brought him lunch, he began to cry. He then said: "This is a day which has been made unenjoyable to us." And he refused to eat.¹³⁵

Salih Al-Murri said:

كان حسان بن أبي سنان إذا مات في جيرانهم ميت، سُمعت من داره النحيب والبكاء، كما يُسمع من دار الميت، فإذا حضر الجنازة ثم انصرف، لم يفطر تلك الليلة، ونظرت إلى ولده وأهل داره عليهم السكينة والخشوع أيامًا.

"When one of Hassan ibn Abi Sinan's neighbors passed away, I would hear from his house crying and weeping like that which is heard from the house of the deceased. And when he would attend a janazah and leave, he would not eat that night. And I would see his children and members of his household in a state of tranquility and contemplation for days afterward."¹³⁶

¹³³ It should be noted while this act is not necessarily sunnah, it is a testimony to how much the pious predecessors would be effected by death. As it is known, when an individual is in grief they often lose their appetite. Therefore this is not something that one should necessarily try to implement as a specific act, rather one should work towards being deeply effected by death as they were.

¹³⁴ Hayatus Salaf Bayn Al-Qawl wal Amal, Pg. 707, Dar Ibn Al-Jawzi, 2012

¹³⁵ Ibid.

¹³⁶ Ibid. Pg. 708

9 CONCLUSION
